

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 18

Job

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 18

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Job

Job 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job was a man who lived in Uz. He was honest inside and out, a man of his word, who was totally devoted to God and hated evil with a passion.
- 1 In the land of Uz there lived a man whose name was Job. This man was blameless and upright; he feared God and shunned evil.
- 2 He had seven sons and three daughters.
- 2 He had seven sons and three daughters,
- 3 He was also very wealthy--seven thousand head of sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred teams of oxen, five hundred donkeys, and a huge staff of servants--the most influential man in all the East!
- 3 and he owned seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred yoke of oxen and five hundred donkeys, and had a large number of servants. He was the greatest man among all the people of the East.
- 4 His sons used to take turns hosting parties in their homes, always inviting their three sisters to join them in their merrymaking.
- 4 His sons used to take turns holding feasts in their homes, and they would invite their three sisters to eat and drink with them.
- 5 When the parties were over, Job would get up early in the morning and sacrifice a burnt offering for each of his children, thinking, "Maybe one of them sinned by defying God inwardly." Job made a habit of this sacrificial atonement, just in case they'd sinned.
- 5 When a period of feasting had run its course, Job would send and have them purified. Early in the morning he would sacrifice a burnt offering for each of them, thinking, "Perhaps my children have sinned and cursed God in their hearts." This was Job's regular custom.
- 6 One day when the angels came to report to GOD, Satan, who was the Designated Accuser, came along with them.

- 6 One day the angels came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan also came with them.
- 7 GOD singled out Satan and said, "What have you been up to?" Satan answered GOD, "Going here and there, checking things out on earth."
- 7 The LORD said to Satan, "Where have you come from?" Satan answered the LORD, "From roaming through the earth and going back and forth in it."
- 8 GOD said to Satan, "Have you noticed my friend Job? There's no one quite like him--honest and true to his word, totally devoted to God and hating evil."
- 8 Then the LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant Job? There is no one on earth like him; he is blameless and upright, a man who fears God and shuns evil."
- 9 Satan retorted, "So do you think Job does all that out of the sheer goodness of his heart?"
- 9 Does Job fear God for nothing? Satan replied.
- 10 Why, no one ever had it so good! You pamper him like a pet, make sure nothing bad ever happens to him or his family or his possessions, bless everything he does--he can't lose!
- 10 Have you not put a hedge around him and his household and everything he has? You have blessed the work of his hands, so that his flocks and herds are spread throughout the land.
- 11 "But what do you think would happen if you reached down and took away everything that is his? He'd curse you right to your face, that's what."
- 11 But stretch out your hand and strike everything he has, and he will surely curse you to your face."
- 12 GOD replied, "We'll see. Go ahead--do what you want with all that is his. Just don't hurt him." Then Satan left the presence of GOD.
- 12 The LORD said to Satan, "Very well, then, everything he has is in your hands, but on the man himself do not lay a finger." Then Satan went out from the presence of the LORD.
- 13 Sometime later, while Job's children were having one of their parties at the home of the oldest son,
- 13 One day when Job's sons and daughters were feasting and drinking wine at the oldest brother's house,

- 14 a messenger came to Job and said, "The oxen were plowing and the donkeys grazing in the field next to us
- 14 a messenger came to Job and said, "The oxen were plowing and the donkeys were grazing nearby,
- 15 when Sabeans attacked. They stole the animals and killed the field hands. I'm the only one to get out alive and tell you what happened."
- 15 and the Sabeans attacked and carried them off. They put the servants to the sword, and I am the only one who has escaped to tell you!"
- 16 While he was still talking, another messenger arrived and said, "Bolts of lightning struck the sheep and the shepherds and fried them--burned them to a crisp. I'm the only one to get out alive and tell you what happened."
- 16 While he was still speaking, another messenger came and said, "The fire of God fell from the sky and burned up the sheep and the servants, and I am the only one who has escaped to tell you!"
- 17 While he was still talking, another messenger arrived and said, "Chaldeans coming from three directions raided the camels and massacred the camel drivers. I'm the only one to get out alive and tell you what happened."
- 17 While he was still speaking, another messenger came and said, "The Chaldeans formed three raiding parties and swept down on your camels and carried them off. They put the servants to the sword, and I am the only one who has escaped to tell you!"
- 18 While he was still talking, another messenger arrived and said, "Your children were having a party at the home of the oldest brother
- 18 While he was still speaking, yet another messenger came and said, "Your sons and daughters were feasting and drinking wine at the oldest brother's house,
- 19 when a tornado swept in off the desert and struck the house. It collapsed on the young people and they died. I'm the only one to get out alive and tell you what happened."
- 19 when suddenly a mighty wind swept in from the desert and struck the four corners of the house. It collapsed on them and they are dead, and I am the only one who has escaped to tell you!"
- 20 Job got to his feet, ripped his robe, shaved his head, then fell to the ground and worshiped:

- 20 At this, Job got up and tore his robe and shaved his head. Then he fell to the ground in worship
- 21 Naked I came from my mother's womb, naked I'll return to the womb of the earth. GOD gives, GOD takes. God's name be ever blessed.
- 21 and said: "Naked I came from my mother's womb, and naked I will depart. The LORD gave and the LORD has taken away; may the name of the LORD be praised."
- 22 Not once through all this did Job sin; not once did he blame God.
- 22 In all this, Job did not sin by charging God with wrongdoing.

Job 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 One day when the angels came to report to GOD, Satan also showed up.
- 1 On another day the angels came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan also came with them to present himself before him.
- 2 GOD singled out Satan, saying, "And what have you been up to?" Satan answered GOD, "Oh, going here and there, checking things out."
- 2 And the LORD said to Satan, "Where have you come from?" Satan answered the LORD, "From roaming through the earth and going back and forth in it."
- 3 Then GOD said to Satan, "Have you noticed my friend Job? There's no one quite like him, is there--honest and true to his word, totally devoted to God and hating evil? He still has a firm grip on his integrity! You tried to trick me into destroying him, but it didn't work."
- 3 Then the LORD said to Satan, "Have you considered my servant Job? There is no one on earth like him; he is blameless and upright, a man who fears God and shuns evil. And he still maintains his integrity, though you incited me against him to ruin him without any reason."
- 4 Satan answered, "A human would do anything to save his life.
- 4 Skin for skin! Satan replied. "A man will give all he has for his own life.
- 5 But what do you think would happen if you reached down and took away his health? He'd curse you to your face, that's what."
- 5 But stretch out your hand and strike his flesh and bones, and he will surely curse you to your face."

- 6 GOD said, "All right. Go ahead--you can do what you like with him. But mind you, don't kill him."
- 6 The LORD said to Satan, "Very well, then, he is in your hands; but you must spare his life."
- 7 Satan left GOD and struck Job with terrible sores. Job was ulcers and scabs from head to foot.
- 7 So Satan went out from the presence of the LORD and afflicted Job with painful sores from the soles of his feet to the top of his head.
- 8 They itched and oozed so badly that he took a piece of broken pottery to scrape himself, then went and sat on a trash heap, among the ashes.
- 8 Then Job took a piece of broken pottery and scraped himself with it as he sat among the ashes.
- 9 His wife said, "Still holding on to your precious integrity, are you? Curse God and be done with it!"
- 9 His wife said to him, "Are you still holding on to your integrity? Curse God and die!"
- 10 He told her, "You're talking like an empty-headed fool. We take the good days from God--why not also the bad days?" Not once through all this did Job sin. He said nothing against God.
- 10 He replied, "You are talking like a foolish woman. Shall we accept good from God, and not trouble?" In all this, Job did not sin in what he said.
- 11 Three of Job's friends heard of all the trouble that had fallen on him. Each traveled from his own country--Eliphaz from Teman, Bildad from Shuhah, Zophar from Naamath--and went together to Job to keep him company and comfort him.
- 11 When Job's three friends, Eliphaz the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite, heard about all the troubles that had come upon him, they set out from their homes and met together by agreement to go and sympathize with him and comfort him.
- 12 When they first caught sight of him, they couldn't believe what they saw--they hardly recognized him! They cried out in lament, ripped their robes, and dumped dirt on their heads as a sign of their grief.
- 12 When they saw him from a distance, they could hardly recognize him; they began to weep aloud, and they tore their robes and sprinkled dust on their heads.

- 13 Then they sat with him on the ground. Seven days and nights they sat there without saying a word. They could see how rotten he felt, how deeply he was suffering.
- 13 Then they sat on the ground with him for seven days and seven nights. No one said a word to him, because they saw how great his suffering was.

Job 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Job broke the silence. He spoke up and cursed his fate:
- 1 After this, Job opened his mouth and cursed the day of his birth.
- 2 (SEE 3:1)
- 2 He said:
- 3 "Obliterate the day I was born. Blank out the night I was conceived!
- 3 May the day of my birth perish, and the night it was said, 'A boy is born!'
- 4 Let it be a black hole in space. May God above forget it ever happened. Erase it from the books!
- 4 That day--may it turn to darkness; may God above not care about it; may no light shine upon it.
- 5 May the day of my birth be buried in deep darkness, shrouded by the fog, swallowed by the night.
- 5 May darkness and deep shadow claim it once more; may a cloud settle over it; may blackness overwhelm its light.
- 6 And the night of my conception--the devil take it! Rip the date off the calendar, delete it from the almanac.
- 6 That night--may thick darkness seize it; may it not be included among the days of the year nor be entered in any of the months.
- 7 Oh, turn that night into pure nothingness-- no sounds of pleasure from that night, ever!
- 7 May that night be barren; may no shout of joy be heard in it.
- 8 May those who are good at cursing curse that day. Unleash the sea beast, Leviathan, on it.
- 8 May those who curse days curse that day, those who are ready to rouse Leviathan.

9 May its morning stars turn to black cinders, waiting for a daylight that never comes, never once seeing the first light of dawn.

9 May its morning stars become dark; may it wait for daylight in vain and not see the first rays of dawn,

10 And why? Because it released me from my mother's womb into a life with so much trouble.

10 for it did not shut the doors of the womb on me to hide trouble from my eyes.

11 "Why didn't I die at birth, my first breath out of the womb my last?

11 Why did I not perish at birth, and die as I came from the womb?

12 Why were there arms to rock me, and breasts for me to drink from?

12 Why were there knees to receive me and breasts that I might be nursed?

13 I could be resting in peace right now, asleep forever, feeling no pain,

13 For now I would be lying down in peace; I would be asleep and at rest

14 In the company of kings and statesmen in their royal ruins,

14 with kings and counselors of the earth, who built for themselves places now lying in ruins,

15 Or with princes resplendent in their gold and silver tombs.

15 with rulers who had gold, who filled their houses with silver.

16 Why wasn't I stillborn and buried with all the babies who never saw light,

16 Or why was I not hidden in the ground like a stillborn child, like an infant who never saw the light of day?

17 Where the wicked no longer trouble anyone and bone-weary people get a long-deserved rest?

17 There the wicked cease from turmoil, and there the weary are at rest.

18 Prisoners sleep undisturbed, never again to wake up to the bark of the guards.

18 Captives also enjoy their ease; they no longer hear the slave driver's shout.

19 The small and the great are equals in that place, and slaves are free from their masters.

19 The small and the great are there, and the slave is freed from his master.

20 "Why does God bother giving light to the miserable, why bother keeping bitter people alive,

20 Why is light given to those in misery, and life to the bitter of soul,

- 21 Those who want in the worst way to die, and can't, who can't imagine anything better than death,
21 to those who long for death that does not come, who search for it more than for hidden treasure,
22 Who count the day of their death and burial the happiest day of their life?
22 who are filled with gladness and rejoice when they reach the grave?
23 What's the point of life when it doesn't make sense, when God blocks all the roads to meaning?
23 Why is life given to a man whose way is hidden, whom God has hedged in?
24 "Instead of bread I get groans for my supper, then leave the table and vomit my anguish.
24 For sighing comes to me instead of food; my groans pour out like water.
25 The worst of my fears has come true, what I've dreaded most has happened.
25 What I feared has come upon me; what I dreaded has happened to me.
26 My repose is shattered, my peace destroyed. No rest for me, ever--death has invaded life."
26 I have no peace, no quietness; I have no rest, but only turmoil."

Job 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Eliphaz from Teman spoke up:
1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite replied:
2 "Would you mind if I said something to you? Under the circumstances it's hard to keep quiet.
2 If someone ventures a word with you, will you be impatient? But who can keep from speaking?
3 You yourself have done this plenty of times, spoken words that clarify, encouraged those who were about to quit.
3 Think how you have instructed many, how you have strengthened feeble hands.

- 4 Your words have put stumbling people on their feet, put fresh hope in people about to collapse.
- 4 Your words have supported those who stumbled; you have strengthened faltering knees.
- 5 But now you're the one in trouble--you're hurting! You've been hit hard and you're reeling from the blow.
- 5 But now trouble comes to you, and you are discouraged; it strikes you, and you are dismayed.
- 6 But shouldn't your devout life give you confidence now? Shouldn't your exemplary life give you hope?
- 6 Should not your piety be your confidence and your blameless ways your hope?
- 7 "Think! Has a truly innocent person ever ended up on the scrap heap? Do genuinely upright people ever lose out in the end?
- 7 Consider now: Who, being innocent, has ever perished? Where were the upright ever destroyed?
- 8 It's my observation that those who plow evil and sow trouble reap evil and trouble.
- 8 As I have observed, those who plow evil and those who sow trouble reap it.
- 9 One breath from God and they fall apart, one blast of his anger and there's nothing left of them.
- 9 At the breath of God they are destroyed; at the blast of his anger they perish.
- 10 The mighty lion, king of the beasts, roars mightily, but when he's toothless he's useless--
- 10 The lions may roar and growl, yet the teeth of the great lions are broken.
- 11 No teeth, no prey--and the cubs wander off to fend for themselves.
- 11 The lion perishes for lack of prey, and the cubs of the lioness are scattered.
- 12 "A word came to me in secret-- a mere whisper of a word, but I heard it clearly.
- 12 A word was secretly brought to me, my ears caught a whisper of it.
- 13 It came in a scary dream one night, after I had fallen into a deep, deep sleep.
- 13 Amid disquieting dreams in the night, when deep sleep falls on men,

14 Dread stared me in the face, and Terror. I was scared to death--I shook from head to foot.
14 fear and trembling seized me and made all my bones shake.
15 A spirit glided right in front of me-- the hair on my head stood on end.
15 A spirit glided past my face, and the hair on my body stood on end.
16 I couldn't tell what it was that appeared there-- a blur . . . and then I heard a muffled voice:
16 It stopped, but I could not tell what it was. A form stood before my eyes, and I heard a hushed voice:
17 "'How can mere mortals be more righteous than God? How can humans be purer than their Creator?
17 'Can a mortal be more righteous than God? Can a man be more pure than his Maker?
18 Why, God doesn't even trust his own servants, doesn't even cheer his angels,
18 If God places no trust in his servants, if he charges his angels with error,
19 So how much less these bodies composed of mud, fragile as moths?
19 how much more those who live in houses of clay, whose foundations are in the dust, who are crushed more readily than a moth!
20 These bodies of ours are here today and gone tomorrow, and no one even notices--gone without a trace.
20 Between dawn and dusk they are broken to pieces; unnoticed, they perish forever.
21 When the tent stakes are ripped up, the tent collapses-- we die and are never the wiser for having lived.'
21 Are not the cords of their tent pulled up, so that they die without wisdom?'

Job 5

MSG

NIV

1 "Call for help, Job, if you think anyone will answer! To which of the holy angels will you turn?
1 Call if you will, but who will answer you? To which of the holy ones will you turn?

- 2 The hot temper of a fool eventually kills him, the jealous anger of a simpleton does her in.
- 2 Resentment kills a fool, and envy slays the simple.
- 3 I've seen it myself--seen fools putting down roots, and then, suddenly, their houses are cursed.
- 3 I myself have seen a fool taking root, but suddenly his house was cursed.
- 4 Their children out in the cold, abused and exploited, with no one to stick up for them.
- 4 His children are far from safety, crushed in court without a defender.
- 5 Hungry people off the street plunder their harvests, cleaning them out completely, taking thorns and all, insatiable for everything they have.
- 5 The hungry consume his harvest, taking it even from among thorns, and the thirsty pant after his wealth.
- 6 Don't blame fate when things go wrong-- trouble doesn't come from nowhere.
- 6 For hardship does not spring from the soil, nor does trouble sprout from the ground.
- 7 It's human! Mortals are born and bred for trouble, as certainly as sparks fly upward.
- 7 Yet man is born to trouble as surely as sparks fly upward.
- 8 "If I were in your shoes, I'd go straight to God, I'd throw myself on the mercy of God.
- 8 But if it were I, I would appeal to God; I would lay my cause before him.
- 9 After all, he's famous for great and unexpected acts; there's no end to his surprises.
- 9 He performs wonders that cannot be fathomed, miracles that cannot be counted.
- 10 He gives rain, for instance, across the wide earth, sends water to irrigate the fields.
- 10 He bestows rain on the earth; he sends water upon the countryside.
- 11 He raises up the down-and-out, gives firm footing to those sinking in grief.
- 11 The lowly he sets on high, and those who mourn are lifted to safety.
- 12 He aborts the schemes of conniving crooks, so that none of their plots come to term.

- 12 He thwarts the plans of the crafty, so that their hands achieve no success.
- 13 He catches the know-it-alls in their conspiracies-- all that intricate intrigue swept out with the trash!
- 13 He catches the wise in their craftiness, and the schemes of the wily are swept away.
- 14 Suddenly they're disoriented, plunged into darkness; they can't see to put one foot in front of the other.
- 14 Darkness comes upon them in the daytime; at noon they grope as in the night.
- 15 But the downtrodden are saved by God, saved from the murderous plots, saved from the iron fist.
- 15 He saves the needy from the sword in their mouth; he saves them from the clutches of the powerful.
- 16 And so the poor continue to hope, while injustice is bound and gagged.
- 16 So the poor have hope, and injustice shuts its mouth.
- 17 "So, what a blessing when God steps in and corrects you! Mind you, don't despise the discipline of Almighty God!
- 17 Blessed is the man whom God corrects; so do not despise the discipline of the Almighty.
- 18 True, he wounds, but he also dresses the wound; the same hand that hurts you, heals you.
- 18 For he wounds, but he also binds up; he injures, but his hands also heal.
- 19 From one disaster after another he delivers you; no matter what the calamity, the evil can't touch you--
- 19 From six calamities he will rescue you; in seven no harm will befall you.
- 20 "In famine, he'll keep you from starving, in war, from being gutted by the sword.
- 20 In famine he will ransom you from death, and in battle from the stroke of the sword.
- 21 You'll be protected from vicious gossip and live fearless through any catastrophe.
- 21 You will be protected from the lash of the tongue, and need not fear when destruction comes.

- 22 You'll shrug off disaster and famine, and stroll fearlessly among wild animals.
- 22 You will laugh at destruction and famine, and need not fear the beasts of the earth.
- 23 You'll be on good terms with rocks and mountains; wild animals will become your good friends.
- 23 For you will have a covenant with the stones of the field, and the wild animals will be at peace with you.
- 24 You'll know that your place on earth is safe, you'll look over your goods and find nothing amiss.
- 24 You will know that your tent is secure; you will take stock of your property and find nothing missing.
- 25 You'll see your children grow up, your family lovely and lissome as orchard grass.
- 25 You will know that your children will be many, and your descendants like the grass of the earth.
- 26 You'll arrive at your grave ripe with many good years, like sheaves of golden grain at harvest.
- 26 You will come to the grave in full vigor, like sheaves gathered in season.
- 27 "Yes, this is the way things are--my word of honor! Take it to heart and you won't go wrong."
- 27 We have examined this, and it is true. So hear it and apply it to yourself.

Job 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job answered:
- 1 Then Job replied:
- 2 "If my misery could be weighed, if you could pile the whole bitter load on the scales,
- 2 If only my anguish could be weighed and all my misery be placed on the scales!
- 3 It would be heavier than all the sand of the sea! Is it any wonder that I'm screaming like a caged cat?

3 It would surely outweigh the sand of the seas-- no wonder my words have been impetuous.

4 The arrows of God Almighty are in me, poison arrows--and I'm poisoned all through! God has dumped the whole works on me.

4 The arrows of the Almighty are in me, my spirit drinks in their poison; God's terrors are marshaled against me.

5 Donkeys bray and cows moo when they run out of pasture-- so don't expect me to keep quiet in this.

5 Does a wild donkey bray when it has grass, or an ox bellow when it has fodder?

6 Do you see what God has dished out for me? It's enough to turn anyone's stomach!

6 Is tasteless food eaten without salt, or is there flavor in the white of an egg?

7 Everything in me is repulsed by it-- it makes me sick.

7 I refuse to touch it; such food makes me ill.

8 "All I want is an answer to one prayer, a last request to be honored:

8 Oh, that I might have my request, that God would grant what I hope for,

9 Let God step on me--squash me like a bug, and be done with me for good.

9 that God would be willing to crush me, to let loose his hand and cut me off!

10 I'd at least have the satisfaction of not having blasphemed the Holy God, before being pressed past the limits.

10 Then I would still have this consolation-- my joy in unrelenting pain-- that I had not denied the words of the Holy One.

11 Where's the strength to keep my hopes up? What future do I have to keep me going?

11 What strength do I have, that I should still hope? What prospects, that I should be patient?

12 Do you think I have nerves of steel? Do you think I'm made of iron?

12 Do I have the strength of stone? Is my flesh bronze?

13 Do you think I can pull myself up by my bootstraps? Why, I don't even have any boots!

13 Do I have any power to help myself, now that success has been driven from me?

14 "When desperate people give up on God Almighty, their friends, at least, should stick with them.

14 A despairing man should have the devotion of his friends, even though he forsakes the fear of the Almighty.

15 But my brothers are fickle as a gulch in the desert-- one day they're gushing with water

15 But my brothers are as undependable as intermittent streams, as the streams that overflow

16 From melting ice and snow cascading out of the mountains,

16 when darkened by thawing ice and swollen with melting snow,

17 But by midsummer they're dry, gullies baked dry in the sun.

17 but that cease to flow in the dry season, and in the heat vanish from their channels.

18 Travelers who spot them and go out of their way for a drink, end up in a waterless gulch and die of thirst.

18 Caravans turn aside from their routes; they go up into the wasteland and perish.

19 Merchant caravans from Tema see them and expect water, tourists from Sheba hope for a cool drink.

19 The caravans of Tema look for water, the traveling merchants of Sheba look in hope.

20 They arrive so confident--but what a disappointment! They get there, and their faces fall!

20 They are distressed, because they had been confident; they arrive there, only to be disappointed.

21 And you, my so-called friends, are no better-- there's nothing to you! One look at a hard scene and you shrink in fear.

21 Now you too have proved to be of no help; you see something dreadful and are afraid.

22 It's not as though I asked you for anything-- I didn't ask you for one red cent--

22 Have I ever said, 'Give something on my behalf, pay a ransom for me from your wealth,

23 Nor did I beg you to go out on a limb for me. So why all this dodging and shuffling?

- 23 deliver me from the hand of the enemy, ransom me from the clutches of the ruthless'?
- 24 "Confront me with the truth and I'll shut up, show me where I've gone off the track.
- 24 Teach me, and I will be quiet; show me where I have been wrong.
- 25 Honest words never hurt anyone, but what's the point of all this pious bluster?
- 25 How painful are honest words! But what do your arguments prove?
- 26 You pretend to tell me what's wrong with my life, but treat my words of anguish as so much hot air.
- 26 Do you mean to correct what I say, and treat the words of a despairing man as wind?
- 27 Are people mere things to you? Are friends just items of profit and loss?
- 27 You would even cast lots for the fatherless and barter away your friend.
- 28 "Look me in the eyes! Do you think I'd lie to your face?
- 28 But now be so kind as to look at me. Would I lie to your face?
- 29 Think it over--no double-talk! Think carefully--my integrity is on the line!
- 29 Relent, do not be unjust; reconsider, for my integrity is at stake.
- 30 Can you detect anything false in what I say? Don't you trust me to discern good from evil?
- 30 Is there any wickedness on my lips? Can my mouth not discern malice?

Job 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Human life is a struggle, isn't it? It's a life sentence to hard labor.
- 1 Does not man have hard service on earth? Are not his days like those of a hired man?
- 2 Like field hands longing for quitting time and working stiff with nothing to hope for but payday,
- 2 Like a slave longing for the evening shadows, or a hired man waiting eagerly for his wages,
- 3 I'm given a life that meanders and goes nowhere-- months of aimlessness, nights of misery!

- 3 so I have been allotted months of futility, and nights of misery have been assigned to me.
- 4 I go to bed and think, 'How long till I can get up?' I toss and turn as the night drags on--and I'm fed up!
- 4 When I lie down I think, 'How long before I get up?' The night drags on, and I toss till dawn.
- 5 I'm covered with maggots and scabs. My skin gets scaly and hard, then oozes with pus.
- 5 My body is clothed with worms and scabs, my skin is broken and festering.
- 6 My days come and go swifter than the click of knitting needles, and then the yarn runs out--an unfinished life!
- 6 My days are swifter than a weaver's shuttle, and they come to an end without hope.
- 7 "God, don't forget that I'm only a puff of air! These eyes have had their last look at goodness.
- 7 Remember, O God, that my life is but a breath; my eyes will never see happiness again.
- 8 And your eyes have seen the last of me; even while you're looking, there'll be nothing left to look at.
- 8 The eye that now sees me will see me no longer; you will look for me, but I will be no more.
- 9 When a cloud evaporates, it's gone for good; those who go to the grave never come back.
- 9 As a cloud vanishes and is gone, so he who goes down to the grave does not return.
- 10 They don't return to visit their families; never again will friends drop in for coffee.
- 10 He will never come to his house again; his place will know him no more.
- 11 "And so I'm not keeping one bit of this quiet, I'm laying it all out on the table; my complaining to high heaven is bitter, but honest.
- 11 Therefore I will not keep silent; I will speak out in the anguish of my spirit, I will complain in the bitterness of my soul.
- 12 Are you going to put a muzzle on me, the way you quiet the sea and still the storm?

12 Am I the sea, or the monster of the deep, that you put me under guard?
13 If I say, 'I'm going to bed, then I'll feel better. A little nap will lift my spirits,'
13 When I think my bed will comfort me and my couch will ease my complaint,
14 You come and so scare me with nightmares and frighten me with ghosts
14 even then you frighten me with dreams and terrify me with visions,
15 That I'd rather strangle in the bedclothes than face this kind of life any longer.
15 so that I prefer strangling and death, rather than this body of mine.
16 I hate this life! Who needs any more of this? Let me alone! There's nothing to my life--it's nothing but smoke.
16 I despise my life; I would not live forever. Let me alone; my days have no meaning.
17 "What are mortals anyway, that you bother with them, that you even give them the time of day?
17 What is man that you make so much of him, that you give him so much attention,
18 That you check up on them every morning, looking in on them to see how they're doing?
18 that you examine him every morning and test him every moment?
19 Let up on me, will you? Can't you even let me spit in peace?
19 Will you never look away from me, or let me alone even for an instant?
20 Even suppose I'd sinned--how would that hurt you? You're responsible for every human being. Don't you have better things to do than pick on me? Why make a federal case out of me?
20 If I have sinned, what have I done to you, O watcher of men? Why have you made me your target? Have I become a burden to you?
21 Why don't you just forgive my sins and start me off with a clean slate? The way things are going, I'll soon be dead. You'll look high and low, but I won't be around."
21 Why do you not pardon my offenses and forgive my sins? For I will soon lie down in the dust; you will search for me, but I will be no more."

Job 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 Bildad from Shuhah was next to speak:
- 1 Then Bildad the Shuhite replied:
- 2 "How can you keep on talking like this? You're talking nonsense, and noisy nonsense at that.
- 2 How long will you say such things? Your words are a blustering wind.
- 3 Does God mess up? Does God Almighty ever get things backwards?
- 3 Does God pervert justice? Does the Almighty pervert what is right?
- 4 It's plain that your children sinned against him-- otherwise, why would God have punished them?
- 4 When your children sinned against him, he gave them over to the penalty of their sin.
- 5 Here's what you must do--and don't put it off any longer: Get down on your knees before God Almighty.
- 5 But if you will look to God and plead with the Almighty,
- 6 If you're as innocent and upright as you say, it's not too late--he'll come running; he'll set everything right again, reestablish your fortunes.
- 6 if you are pure and upright, even now he will rouse himself on your behalf and restore you to your rightful place.
- 7 Even though you're not much right now, you'll end up better than ever.
- 7 Your beginnings will seem humble, so prosperous will your future be.
- 8 "Put the question to our ancestors, study what they learned from their ancestors.
- 8 Ask the former generations and find out what their fathers learned,
- 9 For we're newcomers at this, with a lot to learn, and not too long to learn it.
- 9 for we were born only yesterday and know nothing, and our days on earth are but a shadow.
- 10 So why not let the ancients teach you, tell you what's what, instruct you in what they knew from experience?
- 10 Will they not instruct you and tell you? Will they not bring forth words from their understanding?
- 11 Can mighty pine trees grow tall without soil? Can luscious tomatoes flourish without water?

- 11 Can papyrus grow tall where there is no marsh? Can reeds thrive without water?
- 12 Blossoming flowers look great before they're cut or picked, but without soil or water they wither more quickly than grass.
- 12 While still growing and uncut, they wither more quickly than grass.
- 13 That's what happens to all who forget God-- all their hopes come to nothing.
- 13 Such is the destiny of all who forget God; so perishes the hope of the godless.
- 14 They hang their life from one thin thread, they hitch their fate to a spider web.
- 14 What he trusts in is fragile; what he relies on is a spider's web.
- 15 One jiggle and the thread breaks, one jab and the web collapses.
- 15 He leans on his web, but it gives way; he clings to it, but it does not hold.
- 16 Or they're like weeds springing up in the sunshine, invading the garden,
- 16 He is like a well-watered plant in the sunshine, spreading its shoots over the garden;
- 17 Spreading everywhere, overtaking the flowers, getting a foothold even in the rocks.
- 17 it entwines its roots around a pile of rocks and looks for a place among the stones.
- 18 But when the gardener rips them out by the roots, the garden doesn't miss them one bit.
- 18 But when it is torn from its spot, that place disowns it and says, 'I never saw you.'
- 19 The sooner the godless are gone, the better; then good plants can grow in their place.
- 19 Surely its life withers away, and from the soil other plants grow.
- 20 "There's no way that God will reject a good person, and there is no way he'll help a bad one.
- 20 Surely God does not reject a blameless man or strengthen the hands of evildoers.
- 21 God will let you laugh again; you'll raise the roof with shouts of joy,
- 21 He will yet fill your mouth with laughter and your lips with shouts of joy.

22 With your enemies thoroughly discredited, their house of cards collapsed."

22 Your enemies will be clothed in shame, and the tents of the wicked will be no more."

Job 9

MSG

NIV

1 Job continued by saying:

1 Then Job replied:

2 "So what's new? I know all this. The question is, 'How can mere mortals get right with God?'

2 Indeed, I know that this is true. But how can a mortal be righteous before God?

3 If we wanted to bring our case before him, what chance would we have? Not one in a thousand!

3 Though one wished to dispute with him, he could not answer him one time out of a thousand.

4 God's wisdom is so deep, God's power so immense, who could take him on and come out in one piece?

4 His wisdom is profound, his power is vast. Who has resisted him and come out unscathed?

5 He moves mountains before they know what's happened, flips them on their heads on a whim.

5 He moves mountains without their knowing it and overturns them in his anger.

6 He gives the earth a good shaking up, rocks it down to its very foundations.

6 He shakes the earth from its place and makes its pillars tremble.

7 He tells the sun, 'Don't shine,' and it doesn't; he pulls the blinds on the stars.

7 He speaks to the sun and it does not shine; he seals off the light of the stars.

8 All by himself he stretches out the heavens and strides on the waves of the sea.

8 He alone stretches out the heavens and treads on the waves of the sea.
9 He designed the Big Dipper and Orion, the Pleiades and Alpha Centauri.
9 He is the Maker of the Bear and Orion, the Pleiades and the constellations of the south.
10 We'll never comprehend all the great things he does; his miracle-surprises can't be counted.
10 He performs wonders that cannot be fathomed, miracles that cannot be counted.
11 Somehow, though he moves right in front of me, I don't see him; quietly but surely he's active, and I miss it.
11 When he passes me, I cannot see him; when he goes by, I cannot perceive him.
12 If he steals you blind, who can stop him? Who's going to say, 'Hey, what are you doing?'
12 If he snatches away, who can stop him? Who can say to him, 'What are you doing?'
13 God doesn't hold back on his anger; even dragon-bred monsters cringe before him.
13 God does not restrain his anger; even the cohorts of Rahab cowered at his feet.
14 "So how could I ever argue with him, construct a defense that would influence God?
14 How then can I dispute with him? How can I find words to argue with him?
15 Even though I'm innocent I could never prove it; I can only throw myself on the Judge's mercy.
15 Though I were innocent, I could not answer him; I could only plead with my Judge for mercy.
16 If I called on God and he himself answered me, then, and only then, would I believe that he'd heard me.
16 Even if I summoned him and he responded, I do not believe he would give me a hearing.
17 As it is, he knocks me about from pillar to post, beating me up, black and blue, for no good reason.
17 He would crush me with a storm and multiply my wounds for no reason.

- 18 He won't even let me catch my breath, piles bitterness upon bitterness.
- 18 He would not let me regain my breath but would overwhelm me with misery.
- 19 If it's a question of who's stronger, he wins, hands down! If it's a question of justice, who'll serve him the subpoena?
- 19 If it is a matter of strength, he is mighty! And if it is a matter of justice, who will summon him?
- 20 Even though innocent, anything I say incriminates me; blameless as I am, my defense just makes me sound worse.
- 20 Even if I were innocent, my mouth would condemn me; if I were blameless, it would pronounce me guilty.
- 21 "Believe me, I'm blameless. I don't understand what's going on. I hate my life!
- 21 Although I am blameless, I have no concern for myself; I despise my own life.
- 22 Since either way it ends up the same, I can only conclude that God destroys the good right along with the bad.
- 22 It is all the same; that is why I say, 'He destroys both the blameless and the wicked.'
- 23 When calamity hits and brings sudden death, he folds his arms, aloof from the despair of the innocent.
- 23 When a scourge brings sudden death, he mocks the despair of the innocent.
- 24 He lets the wicked take over running the world, he installs judges who can't tell right from wrong. If he's not responsible, who is?
- 24 When a land falls into the hands of the wicked, he blindfolds its judges. If it is not he, then who is it?
- 25 "My time is short--what's left of my life races off too fast for me to even glimpse the good.
- 25 My days are swifter than a runner; they fly away without a glimpse of joy.
- 26 My life is going fast, like a ship under full sail, like an eagle plummeting to its prey.
- 26 They skim past like boats of papyrus, like eagles swooping down on their prey.

27 Even if I say, 'I'll put all this behind me, I'll look on the bright side and force a smile,'
27 If I say, 'I will forget my complaint, I will change my expression, and smile,'
28 All these troubles would still be like grit in my gut since it's clear you're not going to let up.
28 I still dread all my sufferings, for I know you will not hold me innocent.
29 The verdict has already been handed down--'Guilty!-- so what's the use of protests or appeals?
29 Since I am already found guilty, why should I struggle in vain?
30 Even if I scrub myself all over and wash myself with the strongest soap I can find,
30 Even if I washed myself with soap and my hands with washing soda,
31 It wouldn't last--you'd push me into a pigpen, or worse, so nobody could stand me for the stink.
31 you would plunge me into a slime pit so that even my clothes would detest me.
32 "God and I are not equals; I can't bring a case against him. We'll never enter a courtroom as peers.
32 He is not a man like me that I might answer him, that we might confront each other in court.
33 How I wish we had an arbitrator to step in and let me get on with life--
33 If only there were someone to arbitrate between us, to lay his hand upon us both,
34 To break God's death grip on me, to free me from this terror so I could breathe again.
34 someone to remove God's rod from me, so that his terror would frighten me no more.
35 Then I'd speak up and state my case boldly. As things stand, there is no way I can do it.
35 Then I would speak up without fear of him, but as it now stands with me, I cannot.

Job 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 "I can't stand my life--I hate it! -I'm putting it all out on the table, all the bitterness of my life--I'm holding back nothing."
- 1 I loathe my very life; therefore I will give free rein to my complaint and speak out in the bitterness of my soul.
- 2 Job prayed: "Here's what I want to say: Don't, God, bring in a verdict of guilty without letting me know the charges you're bringing.
- 2 I will say to God: Do not condemn me, but tell me what charges you have against me.
- 3 How does this fit into what you once called 'good'-- giving me a hard time, spurning me, a life you shaped by your very own hands, and then blessing the plots of the wicked?
- 3 Does it please you to oppress me, to spurn the work of your hands, while you smile on the schemes of the wicked?
- 4 You don't look at things the way we mortals do. You're not taken in by appearances, are you?
- 4 Do you have eyes of flesh? Do you see as a mortal sees?
- 5 Unlike us, you're not working against a deadline. You have all eternity to work things out.
- 5 Are your days like those of a mortal or your years like those of a man,
- 6 So what's this all about, anyway--this compulsion to dig up some dirt, to find some skeleton in my closet?
- 6 that you must search out my faults and probe after my sin--
- 7 You know good and well I'm not guilty. You also know no one can help me.
- 7 though you know that I am not guilty and that no one can rescue me from your hand?
- 8 "You made me like a handcrafted piece of pottery-- and now are you going to smash me to pieces?
- 8 Your hands shaped me and made me. Will you now turn and destroy me?
- 9 Don't you remember how beautifully you worked my clay? Will you reduce me now to a mud pie?
- 9 Remember that you molded me like clay. Will you now turn me to dust again?
- 10 Oh, that marvel of conception as you stirred together semen and ovum--
- 10 Did you not pour me out like milk and curdle me like cheese,

11 What a miracle of skin and bone, muscle and brain!

11 clothe me with skin and flesh and knit me together with bones and sinews?

12 You gave me life itself, and incredible love. You watched and guarded every breath I took.

12 You gave me life and showed me kindness, and in your providence watched over my spirit.

13 "But you never told me about this part. I should have known that there was more to it--

13 But this is what you concealed in your heart, and I know that this was in your mind:

14 That if I so much as missed a step, you'd notice and pounce, wouldn't let me get by with a thing.

14 If I sinned, you would be watching me and would not let my offense go unpunished.

15 If I'm truly guilty, I'm doomed. But if I'm innocent, it's no better--I'm still doomed. My belly is full of bitterness. I'm up to my ears in a swamp of affliction.

15 If I am guilty--woe to me! Even if I am innocent, I cannot lift my head, for I am full of shame and drowned in my affliction.

16 I try to make the best of it, try to brave it out, but you're too much for me, relentless, like a lion on the prowl.

16 If I hold my head high, you stalk me like a lion and again display your awesome power against me.

17 You line up fresh witnesses against me. You compound your anger and pile on the grief and pain!

17 You bring new witnesses against me and increase your anger toward me; your forces come against me wave upon wave.

18 "So why did you have me born? I wish no one had ever laid eyes on me!

18 Why then did you bring me out of the womb? I wish I had died before any eye saw me.

19 I wish I'd never lived--a stillborn, buried without ever having breathed.

19 If only I had never come into being, or had been carried straight from the womb to the grave!

20 Isn't it time to call it quits on my life? Can't you let up, and let me smile just once

20 Are not my few days almost over? Turn away from me so I can have a moment's joy
21 Before I die and am buried, before I'm nailed into my coffin, sealed in the ground,
21 before I go to the place of no return, to the land of gloom and deep shadow,
22 And banished for good to the land of the dead, blind in the final dark?"
22 to the land of deepest night, of deep shadow and disorder, where even the light is like darkness."

Job 11

MSG

NIV

1 Now it was the turn of Zophar from Naamath:
1 Then Zophar the Naamathite replied:
2 "What a flood of words! Shouldn't we put a stop to it? Should this kind of loose talk be permitted?
2 Are all these words to go unanswered? Is this talker to be vindicated?
3 Job, do you think you can carry on like this and we'll say nothing? That we'll let you rail and mock and not step in?
3 Will your idle talk reduce men to silence? Will no one rebuke you when you mock?
4 You claim, 'My doctrine is sound and my conduct impeccable.'
4 You say to God, 'My beliefs are flawless and I am pure in your sight.'
5 How I wish God would give you a piece of his mind, tell you what's what!
5 Oh, how I wish that God would speak, that he would open his lips against you
6 I wish he'd show you how wisdom looks from the inside, for true wisdom is mostly 'inside.' But you can be sure of this, you haven't gotten half of what you deserve.
6 and disclose to you the secrets of wisdom, for true wisdom has two sides. Know this: God has even forgotten some of your sin.
7 "Do you think you can explain the mystery of God? Do you think you can diagram God Almighty?"

- 7 Can you fathom the mysteries of God? Can you probe the limits of the Almighty?
- 8 God is far higher than you can imagine, far deeper than you can comprehend,
- 8 They are higher than the heavens--what can you do? They are deeper than the depths of the grave--what can you know?
- 9 Stretching farther than earth's horizons, far wider than the endless ocean.
- 9 Their measure is longer than the earth and wider than the sea.
- 10 If he happens along, throws you in jail then hauls you into court, can you do anything about it?
- 10 If he comes along and confines you in prison and convenes a court, who can oppose him?
- 11 He sees through vain pretensions, spots evil a long way off-- no one pulls the wool over his eyes!
- 11 Surely he recognizes deceitful men; and when he sees evil, does he not take note?
- 12 Hollow men, hollow women, will wise up about the same time mules learn to talk.
- 12 But a witless man can no more become wise than a wild donkey's colt can be born a man.
- 13 "Still, if you set your heart on God and reach out to him,
- 13 Yet if you devote your heart to him and stretch out your hands to him,
- 14 If you scrub your hands of sin and refuse to entertain evil in your home,
- 14 if you put away the sin that is in your hand and allow no evil to dwell in your tent,
- 15 You'll be able to face the world unashamed and keep a firm grip on life, guiltless and fearless.
- 15 then you will lift up your face without shame; you will stand firm and without fear.
- 16 You'll forget your troubles; they'll be like old, faded photographs.
- 16 You will surely forget your trouble, recalling it only as waters gone by.
- 17 Your world will be washed in sunshine, every shadow dispersed by dayspring.
- 17 Life will be brighter than noonday, and darkness will become like morning.

- 18 Full of hope, you'll relax, confident again; you'll look around, sit back, and take it easy.
- 18 You will be secure, because there is hope; you will look about you and take your rest in safety.
- 19 Expansive, without a care in the world, you'll be hunted out by many for your blessing.
- 19 You will lie down, with no one to make you afraid, and many will court your favor.
- 20 But the wicked will see none of this. They're headed down a dead-end road with nothing to look forward to--nothing."
- 20 But the eyes of the wicked will fail, and escape will elude them; their hope will become a dying gasp."

Job 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job answered:
- 1 Then Job replied:
- 2 "I'm sure you speak for all the experts, and when you die there'll be no one left to tell us how to live.
- 2 Doubtless you are the people, and wisdom will die with you!
- 3 But don't forget that I also have a brain-- I don't intend to play second fiddle to you. It doesn't take an expert to know these things.
- 3 But I have a mind as well as you; I am not inferior to you. Who does not know all these things?
- 4 "I'm ridiculed by my friends: 'So that's the man who had conversations with God!' Ridiculed without mercy: 'Look at the man who never did wrong!'
- 4 I have become a laughingstock to my friends, though I called upon God and he answered-- a mere laughingstock, though righteous and blameless!
- 5 It's easy for the well-to-do to point their fingers in blame, for the well-fixed to pour scorn on the strugglers.
- 5 Men at ease have contempt for misfortune as the fate of those whose feet are slipping.

- 6 Crooks reside safely in high-security houses, insolent blasphemers live in luxury; they've bought and paid for a god who'll protect them.
- 6 The tents of marauders are undisturbed, and those who provoke God are secure-- those who carry their god in their hands.
- 7 "But ask the animals what they think--let them teach you; let the birds tell you what's going on.
- 7 But ask the animals, and they will teach you, or the birds of the air, and they will tell you;
- 8 Put your ear to the earth--learn the basics. Listen--the fish in the ocean will tell you their stories.
- 8 or speak to the earth, and it will teach you, or let the fish of the sea inform you.
- 9 Isn't it clear that they all know and agree that GOD is sovereign, that he holds all things in his hand--
- 9 Which of all these does not know that the hand of the LORD has done this?
- 10 Every living soul, yes, every breathing creature?
- 10 In his hand is the life of every creature and the breath of all mankind.
- 11 Isn't this all just common sense, as common as the sense of taste?
- 11 Does not the ear test words as the tongue tastes food?
- 12 Do you think the elderly have a corner on wisdom, that you have to grow old before you understand life?
- 12 Is not wisdom found among the aged? Does not long life bring understanding?
- 13 "True wisdom and real power belong to God; from him we learn how to live, and also what to live for.
- 13 To God belong wisdom and power; counsel and understanding are his.
- 14 If he tears something down, it's down for good; if he locks people up, they're locked up for good.
- 14 What he tears down cannot be rebuilt; the man he imprisons cannot be released.
- 15 If he holds back the rain, there's a drought; if he lets it loose, there's a flood.
- 15 If he holds back the waters, there is drought; if he lets them loose, they devastate the land.

- 16 Strength and success belong to God; both deceived and deceiver must answer to him.
- 16 To him belong strength and victory; both deceived and deceiver are his.
- 17 He strips experts of their vaunted credentials, exposes judges as witless fools.
- 17 He leads counselors away stripped and makes fools of judges.
- 18 He divests kings of their royal garments, then ties a rag around their waists.
- 18 He takes off the shackles put on by kings and ties a loincloth around their waist.
- 19 He strips priests of their robes, and fires high officials from their jobs.
- 19 He leads priests away stripped and overthrows men long established.
- 20 He forces trusted sages to keep silence, deprives elders of their good sense and wisdom.
- 20 He silences the lips of trusted advisers and takes away the discernment of elders.
- 21 He dumps contempt on famous people, disarms the strong and mighty.
- 21 He pours contempt on nobles and disarms the mighty.
- 22 He shines a spotlight into caves of darkness, hauls deepest darkness into the noonday sun.
- 22 He reveals the deep things of darkness and brings deep shadows into the light.
- 23 He makes nations rise and then fall, builds up some and abandons others.
- 23 He makes nations great, and destroys them; he enlarges nations, and disperses them.
- 24 He robs world leaders of their reason, and sends them off into no man's land.
- 24 He deprives the leaders of the earth of their reason; he sends them wandering through a trackless waste.
- 25 They grope in the dark without a clue, lurching and staggering like drunks.
- 25 They grope in darkness with no light; he makes them stagger like drunkards.

Job 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Yes, I've seen all this with my own eyes, heard and understood it with my very own ears.
- 1 My eyes have seen all this, my ears have heard and understood it.
- 2 Everything you know, I know, so I'm not taking a back seat to any of you.
- 2 What you know, I also know; I am not inferior to you.
- 3 I'm taking my case straight to God Almighty; I've had it with you--I'm going directly to God.
- 3 But I desire to speak to the Almighty and to argue my case with God.
- 4 You graffiti my life with lies. You're a bunch of pompous quacks!
- 4 You, however, smear me with lies; you are worthless physicians, all of you!
- 5 I wish you'd shut your mouths-- silence is your only claim to wisdom.
- 5 If only you would be altogether silent! For you, that would be wisdom.
- 6 "Listen now while I make my case, consider my side of things for a change.
- 6 Hear now my argument; listen to the plea of my lips.
- 7 Or are you going to keep on lying 'to do God a service'? to make up stories 'to get him off the hook'?
- 7 Will you speak wickedly on God's behalf? Will you speak deceitfully for him?
- 8 Why do you always take his side? Do you think he needs a lawyer to defend himself?
- 8 Will you show him partiality? Will you argue the case for God?
- 9 How would you fare if you were in the dock? Your lies might convince a jury--but would they convince God?
- 9 Would it turn out well if he examined you? Could you deceive him as you might deceive men?
- 10 He'd reprimand you on the spot if he detected a bias in your witness.
- 10 He would surely rebuke you if you secretly showed partiality.
- 11 Doesn't his splendor put you in awe? Aren't you afraid to speak cheap lies before him?

- 11 Would not his splendor terrify you? Would not the dread of him fall on you?
- 12 Your wise sayings are knickknack wisdom, good for nothing but gathering dust.
- 12 Your maxims are proverbs of ashes; your defenses are defenses of clay.
- 13 "So hold your tongue while I have my say, then I'll take whatever I have coming to me.
- 13 Keep silent and let me speak; then let come to me what may.
- 14 Why do I go out on a limb like this and take my life in my hands?
- 14 Why do I put myself in jeopardy and take my life in my hands?
- 15 Because even if he killed me, I'd keep on hoping. I'd defend my innocence to the very end.
- 15 Though he slay me, yet will I hope in him; I will surely defend my ways to his face.
- 16 Just wait, this is going to work out for the best--my salvation! If I were guilt-stricken do you think I'd be doing this-- laying myself on the line before God?
- 16 Indeed, this will turn out for my deliverance, for no godless man would dare come before him!
- 17 You'd better pay attention to what I'm telling you, listen carefully with both ears.
- 17 Listen carefully to my words; let your ears take in what I say.
- 18 Now that I've laid out my defense, I'm sure that I'll be acquitted.
- 18 Now that I have prepared my case, I know I will be vindicated.
- 19 Can anyone prove charges against me? I've said my piece. I rest my case.
- 19 Can anyone bring charges against me? If so, I will be silent and die.
- 20 "Please, God, I have two requests; grant them so I'll know I count with you:
- 20 Only grant me these two things, O God, and then I will not hide from you:
- 21 First, lay off the afflictions; the terror is too much for me.
- 21 Withdraw your hand far from me, and stop frightening me with your terrors.
- 22 Second, address me directly so I can answer you, or let me speak and then you answer me.

- 22 Then summon me and I will answer, or let me speak, and you reply.
- 23 How many sins have been charged against me? Show me the list--how bad is it?
- 23 How many wrongs and sins have I committed? Show me my offense and my sin.
- 24 Why do you stay hidden and silent? Why treat me like I'm your enemy?
- 24 Why do you hide your face and consider me your enemy?
- 25 Why kick me around like an old tin can? Why beat a dead horse?
- 25 Will you torment a windblown leaf? Will you chase after dry chaff?
- 26 You compile a long list of mean things about me, even hold me accountable for the sins of my youth.
- 26 For you write down bitter things against me and make me inherit the sins of my youth.
- 27 You hobble me so I can't move about. You watch every move I make, and brand me as a dangerous character.
- 27 You fasten my feet in shackles; you keep close watch on all my paths by putting marks on the soles of my feet.
- 28 "Like something rotten, human life fast decomposes, like a moth-eaten shirt or a mildewed blouse.
- 28 So man wastes away like something rotten, like a garment eaten by moths.

Job 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 "We're all adrift in the same boat: too few days, too many troubles.
- 1 Man born of woman is of few days and full of trouble.
- 2 We spring up like wildflowers in the desert and then wilt, transient as the shadow of a cloud.
- 2 He springs up like a flower and withers away; like a fleeting shadow, he does not endure.
- 3 Do you occupy your time with such fragile wisps? Why even bother hauling me into court?
- 3 Do you fix your eye on such a one? Will you bring him before you for judgment?

- 4 There's nothing much to us to start with; how do you expect us to amount to anything?
- 4 Who can bring what is pure from the impure? No one!
- 5 Mortals have a limited life span. You've already decided how long we'll live-- you set the boundary and no one can cross it.
- 5 Man's days are determined; you have decreed the number of his months and have set limits he cannot exceed.
- 6 So why not give us a break? Ease up! Even ditchdiggers get occasional days off.
- 6 So look away from him and let him alone, till he has put in his time like a hired man.
- 7 For a tree there is always hope. Chop it down and it still has a chance-- its roots can put out fresh sprouts.
- 7 At least there is hope for a tree: If it is cut down, it will sprout again, and its new shoots will not fail.
- 8 Even if its roots are old and gnarled, its stump long dormant,
- 8 Its roots may grow old in the ground and its stump die in the soil,
- 9 At the first whiff of water it comes to life, buds and grows like a sapling.
- 9 yet at the scent of water it will bud and put forth shoots like a plant.
- 10 But men and women? They die and stay dead. They breathe their last, and that's it.
- 10 But man dies and is laid low; he breathes his last and is no more.
- 11 Like lakes and rivers that have dried up, parched reminders of what once was,
- 11 As water disappears from the sea or a riverbed becomes parched and dry,
- 12 So mortals lie down and never get up, never wake up again--never.
- 12 so man lies down and does not rise; till the heavens are no more, men will not awake or be roused from their sleep.
- 13 Why don't you just bury me alive, get me out of the way until your anger cools? But don't leave me there! Set a date when you'll see me again.
- 13 If only you would hide me in the grave and conceal me till your anger has passed! If only you would set me a time and then remember me!
- 14 If we humans die, will we live again? That's my question. All through these difficult days I keep hoping, waiting for the final change--for

resurrection!

- 14 If a man dies, will he live again? All the days of my hard service I will wait for my renewal to come.
- 15 Homesick with longing for the creature you made, you'll call--and I'll answer!
- 15 You will call and I will answer you; you will long for the creature your hands have made.
- 16 You'll watch over every step I take, but you won't keep track of my missteps.
- 16 Surely then you will count my steps but not keep track of my sin.
- 17 My sins will be stuffed in a sack and thrown into the sea--sunk in deep ocean.
- 17 My offenses will be sealed up in a bag; you will cover over my sin.
- 18 "Meanwhile, mountains wear down and boulders break up,
- 18 But as a mountain erodes and crumbles and as a rock is moved from its place,
- 19 Stones wear smooth and soil erodes, as you relentlessly grind down our hope.
- 19 as water wears away stones and torrents wash away the soil, so you destroy man's hope.
- 20 You're too much for us. As always, you get the last word. We don't like it and our faces show it, but you send us off anyway.
- 20 You overpower him once for all, and he is gone; you change his countenance and send him away.
- 21 If our children do well for themselves, we never know it; if they do badly, we're spared the hurt.
- 21 If his sons are honored, he does not know it; if they are brought low, he does not see it.
- 22 Body and soul, that's it for us-- a lifetime of pain, a lifetime of sorrow."
- 22 He feels but the pain of his own body and mourns only for himself."

Job 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 Eliphaz of Teman spoke a second time:

- 1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite replied:
- 2 "If you were truly wise, would you sound so much like a windbag, belching hot air?
- 2 Would a wise man answer with empty notions or fill his belly with the hot east wind?
- 3 Would you talk nonsense in the middle of a serious argument, babbling baloney?
- 3 Would he argue with useless words, with speeches that have no value?
- 4 Look at you! You trivialize religion, turn spiritual conversation into empty gossip.
- 4 But you even undermine piety and hinder devotion to God.
- 5 It's your sin that taught you to talk this way. You chose an education in fraud.
- 5 Your sin prompts your mouth; you adopt the tongue of the crafty.
- 6 Your own words have exposed your guilt. It's nothing I've said--you've incriminated yourself!
- 6 Your own mouth condemns you, not mine; your own lips testify against you.
- 7 Do you think you're the first person to have to deal with these things? Have you been around as long as the hills?
- 7 Are you the first man ever born? Were you brought forth before the hills?
- 8 Were you listening in when God planned all this? Do you think you're the only one who knows anything?
- 8 Do you listen in on God's council? Do you limit wisdom to yourself?
- 9 What do you know that we don't know? What insights do you have that we've missed?
- 9 What do you know that we do not know? What insights do you have that we do not have?
- 10 Gray beards and white hair back us up-- old folks who've been around a lot longer than you.
- 10 The gray-haired and the aged are on our side, men even older than your father.
- 11 Are God's promises not enough for you, spoken so gently and tenderly?
- 11 Are God's consolations not enough for you, words spoken gently to you?
- 12 Why do you let your emotions take over, lashing out and spitting fire,

12 Why has your heart carried you away, and why do your eyes flash,
13 Pitting your whole being against God by letting words like this come
out of your mouth?
13 so that you vent your rage against God and pour out such words from
your mouth?
14 Do you think it's possible for any mere mortal to be sinless in God's
sight, for anyone born of a human mother to get it all together?
14 What is man, that he could be pure, or one born of woman, that he could
be righteous?
15 Why, God can't even trust his holy angels. He sees the flaws in the very
heavens themselves,
15 If God places no trust in his holy ones, if even the heavens are not pure
in his eyes,
16 So how much less we humans, smelly and foul, who lap up evil like
water?
16 how much less man, who is vile and corrupt, who drinks up evil like
water!
17 "I've a thing or two to tell you, so listen up! I'm letting you in on my
views;
17 Listen to me and I will explain to you; let me tell you what I have seen,
18 It's what wise men and women have always taught, holding nothing
back from what they were taught
18 what wise men have declared, hiding nothing received from their fathers
19 By their parents, back in the days when they had this land all to
themselves:
19 (to whom alone the land was given when no alien passed among them):
20 Those who live by their own rules, not God's, can expect nothing but
trouble, and the longer they live, the worse it gets.
20 All his days the wicked man suffers torment, the ruthless through all the
years stored up for him.
21 Every little sound terrifies them. Just when they think they have it
made, disaster strikes.
21 Terrifying sounds fill his ears; when all seems well, marauders attack
him.
22 They despair of things ever getting better-- they're on the list of people
for whom things always turn out for the worst.

22 He despairs of escaping the darkness; he is marked for the sword.
23 They wander here and there, never knowing where the next meal is coming from-- every day is doomsday!
23 He wanders about--food for vultures; he knows the day of darkness is at hand.
24 They live in constant terror, always with their backs up against the wall
24 Distress and anguish fill him with terror; they overwhelm him, like a king poised to attack,
25 Because they insist on shaking their fists at God, defying God Almighty to his face,
25 because he shakes his fist at God and vaunts himself against the Almighty,
26 Always and ever at odds with God, always on the defensive.
26 defiantly charging against him with a thick, strong shield.
27 "Even if they're the picture of health, trim and fit and youthful,
27 Though his face is covered with fat and his waist bulges with flesh,
28 They'll end up living in a ghost town sleeping in a hovel not fit for a dog, a ramshackle shack.
28 he will inhabit ruined towns and houses where no one lives, houses crumbling to rubble.
29 They'll never get ahead, never amount to a hill of beans.
29 He will no longer be rich and his wealth will not endure, nor will his possessions spread over the land.
30 And then death--don't think they'll escape that! They'll end up shriveled weeds, brought down by a puff of God's breath.
30 He will not escape the darkness; a flame will wither his shoots, and the breath of God's mouth will carry him away.
31 There's a lesson here: Whoever invests in lies, gets lies for interest,
31 Let him not deceive himself by trusting what is worthless, for he will get nothing in return.
32 Paid in full before the due date. Some investment!
32 Before his time he will be paid in full, and his branches will not flourish.
33 They'll be like fruit frost-killed before it ripens, like buds sheared off before they bloom.

- 33 He will be like a vine stripped of its unripe grapes, like an olive tree shedding its blossoms.
- 34 The godless are fruitless--a barren crew; a life built on bribes goes up in smoke.
- 34 For the company of the godless will be barren, and fire will consume the tents of those who love bribes.
- 35 They have sex with sin and give birth to evil. Their lives are wombs for breeding deceit."
- 35 They conceive trouble and give birth to evil; their womb fashions deceit."

Job 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Job defended himself:
- 1 Then Job replied:
- 2 "I've had all I can take of your talk. What a bunch of miserable comforters!
- 2 I have heard many things like these; miserable comforters are you all!
- 3 Is there no end to your windbag speeches? What's your problem that you go on and on like this?
- 3 Will your long-winded speeches never end? What ails you that you keep on arguing?
- 4 If you were in my shoes, I could talk just like you. I could put together a terrific harangue and really let you have it.
- 4 I also could speak like you, if you were in my place; I could make fine speeches against you and shake my head at you.
- 5 But I'd never do that. I'd console and comfort, make things better, not worse!
- 5 But my mouth would encourage you; comfort from my lips would bring you relief.
- 6 "When I speak up, I feel no better; if I say nothing, that doesn't help either.
- 6 Yet if I speak, my pain is not relieved; and if I refrain, it does not go away.

7 I feel worn down. God, you have wasted me totally--me and my family!
7 Surely, O God, you have worn me out; you have devastated my entire household.
8 You've shriveled me like a dried prune, showing the world that you're against me. My gaunt face stares back at me from the mirror, a mute witness to your treatment of me.
8 You have bound me--and it has become a witness; my gauntness rises up and testifies against me.
9 Your anger tears at me, your teeth rip me to shreds, your eyes burn holes in me--God, my enemy!
9 God assails me and tears me in his anger and gnashes his teeth at me; my opponent fastens on me his piercing eyes.
10 People take one look at me and gasp. Contemptuous, they slap me around and gang up against me.
10 Men open their mouths to jeer at me; they strike my cheek in scorn and unite together against me.
11 And God just stands there and lets them do it, lets wicked people do what they want with me.
11 God has turned me over to evil men and thrown me into the clutches of the wicked.
12 I was contentedly minding my business when God beat me up. He grabbed me by the neck and threw me around. He set me up as his target,
12 All was well with me, but he shattered me; he seized me by the neck and crushed me. He has made me his target;
13 then rounded up archers to shoot at me. Merciless, they shot me full of arrows; bitter bile poured from my gut to the ground.
13 his archers surround me. Without pity, he pierces my kidneys and spills my gall on the ground.
14 He burst in on me, onslaught after onslaught, charging me like a mad bull.
14 Again and again he bursts upon me; he rushes at me like a warrior.
15 "I sewed myself a shroud and wore it like a shirt; I lay face down in the dirt.
15 I have sewed sackcloth over my skin and buried my brow in the dust.
16 Now my face is blotched red from weeping; look at the dark shadows under my eyes,

16 My face is red with weeping, deep shadows ring my eyes;
17 Even though I've never hurt a soul and my prayers are sincere!
17 yet my hands have been free of violence and my prayer is pure.
18 "O Earth, don't cover up the wrong done to me! Don't muffle my cry!
18 O earth, do not cover my blood; may my cry never be laid to rest!
19 There must be Someone in heaven who knows the truth about me, in
highest heaven, some Attorney who can clear my name--
19 Even now my witness is in heaven; my advocate is on high.
20 My Champion, my Friend, while I'm weeping my eyes out before God.
20 My intercessor is my friend as my eyes pour out tears to God;
21 I appeal to the One who represents mortals before God as a neighbor
stands up for a neighbor.
21 on behalf of a man he pleads with God as a man pleads for his friend.
22 "Only a few years are left before I set out on the road of no return.
22 Only a few years will pass before I go on the journey of no return.

Job 17

MSG

NIV

1 "My spirit is broken, my days used up, my grave dug and waiting.
1 My spirit is broken, my days are cut short, the grave awaits me.
2 See how these mockers close in on me? How long do I have to put up
with their insolence?
2 Surely mockers surround me; my eyes must dwell on their hostility.
3 "O God, pledge your support for me. Give it to me in writing, with your
signature. You're the only one who can do it!
3 Give me, O God, the pledge you demand. Who else will put up security
for me?
4 These people are so useless! You know firsthand how stupid they can be.
You wouldn't let them have the last word, would you?
4 You have closed their minds to understanding; therefore you will not let
them triumph.
5 Those who betray their own friends leave a legacy of abuse to their
children.

- 5 If a man denounces his friends for reward, the eyes of his children will fail.
- 6 "God, you've made me the talk of the town-- people spit in my face;
6 God has made me a byword to everyone, a man in whose face people spit.
- 7 I can hardly see from crying so much; I'm nothing but skin and bones.
7 My eyes have grown dim with grief; my whole frame is but a shadow.
- 8 Decent people can't believe what they're seeing; the good-hearted wake up and insist I've given up on God.
- 8 Upright men are appalled at this; the innocent are aroused against the ungodly.
- 9 "But principled people hold tight, keep a firm grip on life, sure that their clean, pure hands will get stronger and stronger!
- 9 Nevertheless, the righteous will hold to their ways, and those with clean hands will grow stronger.
- 10 "Maybe you'd all like to start over, to try it again, the bunch of you. So far I haven't come across one scrap of wisdom in anything you've said.
- 10 But come on, all of you, try again! I will not find a wise man among you.
- 11 My life's about over. All my plans are smashed, all my hopes are snuffed out--
- 11 My days have passed, my plans are shattered, and so are the desires of my heart.
- 12 My hope that night would turn into day, my hope that dawn was about to break.
- 12 These men turn night into day; in the face of darkness they say, 'Light is near.'
- 13 If all I have to look forward to is a home in the graveyard, if my only hope for comfort is a well-built coffin,
- 13 If the only home I hope for is the grave, if I spread out my bed in darkness,
- 14 If a family reunion means going six feet under, and the only family that shows up is worms,
- 14 if I say to corruption, 'You are my father,' and to the worm, 'My mother' or 'My sister,'
- 15 Do you call that hope? Who on earth could find any hope in that?

- 15 where then is my hope? Who can see any hope for me?
16 No. If hope and I are to be buried together, I suppose you'll all come to the double funeral!"
16 Will it go down to the gates of death? Will we descend together into the dust?"

Job 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Bildad from Shuhah chimed in:
1 Then Bildad the Shuhite replied:
2 "How monotonous these word games are getting! Get serious! We need to get down to business.
2 When will you end these speeches? Be sensible, and then we can talk.
3 Why do you treat your friends like slow-witted animals? You look down on us as if we don't know anything.
3 Why are we regarded as cattle and considered stupid in your sight?
4 Why are you working yourself up like this? Do you want the world redesigned to suit you? Should reality be suspended to accommodate you?
4 You who tear yourself to pieces in your anger, is the earth to be abandoned for your sake? Or must the rocks be moved from their place?
5 "Here's the rule: The light of the wicked is put out. Their flame dies down and is extinguished.
5 The lamp of the wicked is snuffed out; the flame of his fire stops burning.
6 Their house goes dark-- every lamp in the place goes out.
6 The light in his tent becomes dark; the lamp beside him goes out.
7 Their strong strides weaken, falter; they stumble into their own traps.
7 The vigor of his step is weakened; his own schemes throw him down.
8 They get all tangled up in their own red tape,
8 His feet thrust him into a net and he wanders into its mesh.
9 Their feet are grabbed and caught, their necks in a noose.
9 A trap seizes him by the heel; a snare holds him fast.
10 They trip on ropes they've hidden, and fall into pits they've dug themselves.

10 A noose is hidden for him on the ground; a trap lies in his path.
11 Terrors come at them from all sides. They run helter-skelter.
11 Terrors startle him on every side and dog his every step.
12 The hungry grave is ready to gobble them up for supper,
12 Calamity is hungry for him; disaster is ready for him when he falls.
13 To lay them out for a gourmet meal, a treat for ravenous Death.
13 It eats away parts of his skin; death's firstborn devours his limbs.
14 They are snatched from their home sweet home and marched straight to the death house.
14 He is torn from the security of his tent and marched off to the king of terrors.
15 Their lives go up in smoke; acid rain soaks their ruins.
15 Fire resides in his tent; burning sulfur is scattered over his dwelling.
16 Their roots rot and their branches wither.
16 His roots dry up below and his branches wither above.
17 They'll never again be remembered-- nameless in unmarked graves.
17 The memory of him perishes from the earth; he has no name in the land.
18 They are plunged from light into darkness, banished from the world.
18 He is driven from light into darkness and is banished from the world.
19 And they leave empty-handed--not one single child-- nothing to show for their life on this earth.
19 He has no offspring or descendants among his people, no survivor where once he lived.
20 Westerners are aghast at their fate, easterners are horrified:
20 Men of the west are appalled at his fate; men of the east are seized with horror.
21 'Oh no! So this is what happens to perverse people. This is how the God-ignorant end up!'"
21 Surely such is the dwelling of an evil man; such is the place of one who knows not God."

Job 19

MSG

NIV

1 Job answered:

- 1 Then Job replied:
- 2 "How long are you going to keep battering away at me, pounding me with these harangues?
- 2 How long will you torment me and crush me with words?
- 3 Time after time after time you jump all over me. Do you have no conscience, abusing me like this?
- 3 Ten times now you have reproached me; shamelessly you attack me.
- 4 Even if I have, somehow or other, gotten off the track, what business is that of yours?
- 4 If it is true that I have gone astray, my error remains my concern alone.
- 5 Why do you insist on putting me down, using my troubles as a stick to beat me?
- 5 If indeed you would exalt yourselves above me and use my humiliation against me,
- 6 Tell it to God--he's the one behind all this, he's the one who dragged me into this mess.
- 6 then know that God has wronged me and drawn his net around me.
- 7 "Look at me--I shout 'Murder!' and I'm ignored; I call for help and no one bothers to stop.
- 7 Though I cry, 'I've been wronged!' I get no response; though I call for help, there is no justice.
- 8 God threw a barricade across my path--I'm stymied; he turned out all the lights--I'm stuck in the dark.
- 8 He has blocked my way so I cannot pass; he has shrouded my paths in darkness.
- 9 He destroyed my reputation, robbed me of all self-respect.
- 9 He has stripped me of my honor and removed the crown from my head.
- 10 He tore me apart piece by piece--I'm ruined! Then he yanked out hope by the roots.
- 10 He tears me down on every side till I am gone; he uproots my hope like a tree.
- 11 He's angry with me--oh, how he's angry! He treats me like his worst enemy.
- 11 His anger burns against me; he counts me among his enemies.
- 12 He has launched a major campaign against me, using every weapon he can think of, coming at me from all sides at once.

12 His troops advance in force; they build a siege ramp against me and encamp around my tent.

13 "God alienated my family from me;

13 He has alienated my brothers from me; my acquaintances are completely estranged from me.

14 everyone who knows me avoids me. My relatives and friends have all left; houseguests forget I ever existed.

14 My kinsmen have gone away; my friends have forgotten me.

15 The servant girls treat me like a bum off the street, look at me like they've never seen me before.

15 My guests and my maidservants count me a stranger; they look upon me as an alien.

16 I call my attendant and he ignores me, ignores me even though I plead with him.

16 I summon my servant, but he does not answer, though I beg him with my own mouth.

17 My wife can't stand to be around me anymore. I'm repulsive to my family.

17 My breath is offensive to my wife; I am loathsome to my own brothers.

18 Even street urchins despise me; when I come out, they taunt and jeer.

18 Even the little boys scorn me; when I appear, they ridicule me.

19 Everyone I've ever been close to abhors me; my dearest loved ones reject me.

19 All my intimate friends detest me; those I love have turned against me.

20 I'm nothing but a bag of bones; my life hangs by a thread.

20 I am nothing but skin and bones; I have escaped with only the skin of my teeth.

21 "Oh, friends, dear friends, take pity on me. God has come down hard on me!

21 Have pity on me, my friends, have pity, for the hand of God has struck me.

22 Do you have to be hard on me too? Don't you ever tire of abusing me?

22 Why do you pursue me as God does? Will you never get enough of my flesh?

23 "If only my words were written in a book--

23 Oh, that my words were recorded, that they were written on a scroll,

24 better yet, chiseled in stone!
24 that they were inscribed with an iron tool on lead, or engraved in rock forever!
25 Still, I know that God lives--the One who gives me back my life-- and eventually he'll take his stand on earth.
25 I know that my Redeemer lives, and that in the end he will stand upon the earth.
26 And I'll see him--even though I get skinned alive!--
26 And after my skin has been destroyed, yet in my flesh I will see God;
27 see God myself, with my very own eyes. Oh, how I long for that day!
27 I myself will see him with my own eyes--I, and not another. How my heart yearns within me!
28 "If you're thinking, 'How can we get through to him, get him to see that his trouble is all his own fault?'
28 If you say, 'How we will hound him, since the root of the trouble lies in him, '
29 Forget it. Start worrying about yourselves. Worry about your own sins and God's coming judgment, for judgment is most certainly on the way."
29 you should fear the sword yourselves; for wrath will bring punishment by the sword, and then you will know that there is judgment. "

Job 20

MSG

NIV

1 Zophar from Naamath again took his turn:
1 Then Zophar the Naamathite replied:
2 "I can't believe what I'm hearing! You've put my teeth on edge, my stomach in a knot.
2 My troubled thoughts prompt me to answer because I am greatly disturbed.
3 How dare you insult my intelligence like this! Well, here's a piece of my mind!
3 I hear a rebuke that dishonors me, and my understanding inspires me to reply.

4 "Don't you even know the basics, how things have been since the earliest days, when Adam and Eve were first placed on earth?
4 Surely you know how it has been from of old, ever since man was placed on the earth,
5 The good times of the wicked are short-lived; godless joy is only momentary.
5 that the mirth of the wicked is brief, the joy of the godless lasts but a moment.
6 The evil might become world famous, strutting at the head of the celebrity parade,
6 Though his pride reaches to the heavens and his head touches the clouds,
7 But still end up in a pile of dung. Acquaintances look at them with disgust and say, 'What's that?'
7 he will perish forever, like his own dung; those who have seen him will say, 'Where is he?'
8 They fly off like a dream that can't be remembered, like a shadowy illusion that vanishes in the light.
8 Like a dream he flies away, no more to be found, banished like a vision of the night.
9 Though once notorious public figures, now they're nobodies, unnoticed, whether they come or go.
9 The eye that saw him will not see him again; his place will look on him no more.
10 Their children will go begging on skid row, and they'll have to give back their ill-gotten gain.
10 His children must make amends to the poor; his own hands must give back his wealth.
11 Right in the prime of life, and youthful and vigorous, they'll die.
11 The youthful vigor that fills his bones will lie with him in the dust.
12 "They savor evil as a delicacy, roll it around on their tongues,
12 Though evil is sweet in his mouth and he hides it under his tongue,
13 Prolong the flavor, a dalliance in decadence-- real gourmets of evil!
13 though he cannot bear to let it go and keeps it in his mouth,
14 But then they get stomach cramps, a bad case of food poisoning.
14 yet his food will turn sour in his stomach; it will become the venom of serpents within him.

- 15 They gag on all that rich food; God makes them vomit it up.
- 15 He will spit out the riches he swallowed; God will make his stomach vomit them up.
- 16 They gorge on evil, make a diet of that poison-- a deadly diet--and it kills them.
- 16 He will suck the poison of serpents; the fangs of an adder will kill him.
- 17 No quiet picnics for them beside gentle streams with fresh-baked bread and cheese, and tall, cool drinks.
- 17 He will not enjoy the streams, the rivers flowing with honey and cream.
- 18 They spit out their food half-chewed, unable to relax and enjoy anything they've worked for.
- 18 What he toiled for he must give back uneaten; he will not enjoy the profit from his trading.
- 19 And why? Because they exploited the poor, took what never belonged to them.
- 19 For he has oppressed the poor and left them destitute; he has seized houses he did not build.
- 20 "Such God-denying people are never content with what they have or who they are; their greed drives them relentlessly.
- 20 Surely he will have no respite from his craving; he cannot save himself by his treasure.
- 21 They plunder everything but they can't hold on to any of it.
- 21 Nothing is left for him to devour; his prosperity will not endure.
- 22 Just when they think they have it all, disaster strikes; they're served up a plate full of misery.
- 22 In the midst of his plenty, distress will overtake him; the full force of misery will come upon him.
- 23 When they've filled their bellies with that, God gives them a taste of his anger, and they get to chew on that for a while.
- 23 When he has filled his belly, God will vent his burning anger against him and rain down his blows upon him.
- 24 As they run for their lives from one disaster, they run smack into another.
- 24 Though he flees from an iron weapon, a bronze-tipped arrow pierces him.

25 They're knocked around from pillar to post, beaten to within an inch of their lives. They're trapped in a house of horrors,
25 He pulls it out of his back, the gleaming point out of his liver. Terrors will come over him;
26 and see their loot disappear down a black hole. Their lives are a total loss-- not a penny to their name, not so much as a bean.
26 total darkness lies in wait for his treasures. A fire unfanned will consume him and devour what is left in his tent.
27 God will strip them of their sin-soaked clothes and hang their dirty laundry out for all to see.
27 The heavens will expose his guilt; the earth will rise up against him.
28 Life is a complete wipeout for them, nothing surviving God's wrath.
28 A flood will carry off his house, rushing waters on the day of God's wrath.
29 There! That's God's blueprint for the wicked-- what they have to look forward to."
29 Such is the fate God allots the wicked, the heritage appointed for them by God."

Job 21

MSG

NIV

1 Job replied:
1 Then Job replied:
2 "Now listen to me carefully, please listen, at least do me the favor of listening.
2 Listen carefully to my words; let this be the consolation you give me.
3 Put up with me while I have my say-- then you can mock me later to your heart's content.
3 Bear with me while I speak, and after I have spoken, mock on.
4 "It's not you I'm complaining to--it's God. Is it any wonder I'm getting fed up with his silence?
4 Is my complaint directed to man? Why should I not be impatient?
5 Take a good look at me. Aren't you appalled by what's happened? No! Don't say anything. I can do without your comments.

- 5 Look at me and be astonished; clap your hand over your mouth.
6 When I look back, I go into shock, my body is racked with spasms.
6 When I think about this, I am terrified; trembling seizes my body.
7 Why do the wicked have it so good, live to a ripe old age and get rich?
7 Why do the wicked live on, growing old and increasing in power?
8 They get to see their children succeed, get to watch and enjoy their grandchildren.
8 They see their children established around them, their offspring before their eyes.
9 Their homes are peaceful and free from fear; they never experience God's disciplining rod.
9 Their homes are safe and free from fear; the rod of God is not upon them.
10 Their bulls breed with great vigor and their cows calve without fail.
10 Their bulls never fail to breed; their cows calve and do not miscarry.
11 They send their children out to play and watch them frolic like spring lambs.
11 They send forth their children as a flock; their little ones dance about.
12 They make music with fiddles and flutes, have good times singing and dancing.
12 They sing to the music of tambourine and harp; they make merry to the sound of the flute.
13 They have a long life on easy street, and die painlessly in their sleep.
13 They spend their years in prosperity and go down to the grave in peace.
14 They say to God, 'Get lost! We've no interest in you or your ways.
14 Yet they say to God, 'Leave us alone! We have no desire to know your ways.
15 Why should we have dealings with God Almighty? What's there in it for us?'
15 Who is the Almighty, that we should serve him? What would we gain by praying to him?'
16 But they're wrong, dead wrong--they're not gods. It's beyond me how they can carry on like this!
16 But their prosperity is not in their own hands, so I stand aloof from the counsel of the wicked.
17 "Still, how often does it happen that the wicked fail, or disaster strikes, or they get their just deserts?

- 17 Yet how often is the lamp of the wicked snuffed out? How often does calamity come upon them, the fate God allots in his anger?
- 18 How often are they blown away by bad luck? Not very often.
- 18 How often are they like straw before the wind, like chaff swept away by a gale?
- 19 You might say, 'God is saving up the punishment for their children.' I say, 'Give it to them right now so they'll know what they've done!'
- 19 It is said, 'God stores up a man's punishment for his sons.' Let him repay the man himself, so that he will know it!
- 20 They deserve to experience the effects of their evil, feel the full force of God's wrath firsthand.
- 20 Let his own eyes see his destruction; let him drink of the wrath of the Almighty.
- 21 What do they care what happens to their families after they're safely tucked away in the grave?
- 21 For what does he care about the family he leaves behind when his allotted months come to an end?
- 22 "But who are we to tell God how to run his affairs? He's dealing with matters that are way over our heads.
- 22 Can anyone teach knowledge to God, since he judges even the highest?
- 23 Some people die in the prime of life, with everything going for them--
- 23 One man dies in full vigor, completely secure and at ease,
- 24 fat and sassy.
- 24 his body well nourished, his bones rich with marrow.
- 25 Others die bitter and bereft, never getting a taste of happiness.
- 25 Another man dies in bitterness of soul, never having enjoyed anything good.
- 26 They're laid out side by side in the cemetery, where the worms can't tell one from the other.
- 26 Side by side they lie in the dust, and worms cover them both.
- 27 "I'm not deceived. I know what you're up to, the plans you're cooking up to bring me down.
- 27 I know full well what you are thinking, the schemes by which you would wrong me.
- 28 Naively you claim that the castles of tyrants fall to pieces, that the achievements of the wicked collapse.

- 28 You say, 'Where now is the great man's house, the tents where wicked men lived?'
- 29 Have you ever asked world travelers how they see it? Have you not listened to their stories
- 29 Have you never questioned those who travel? Have you paid no regard to their accounts--
- 30 Of evil men and women who got off scot-free, who never had to pay for their wickedness?
- 30 that the evil man is spared from the day of calamity, that he is delivered from the day of wrath?
- 31 Did anyone ever confront them with their crimes? Did they ever have to face the music?
- 31 Who denounces his conduct to his face? Who repays him for what he has done?
- 32 Not likely--they're given fancy funerals with all the trimmings,
- 32 He is carried to the grave, and watch is kept over his tomb.
- 33 Gently lowered into expensive graves, with everyone telling lies about how wonderful they were.
- 33 The soil in the valley is sweet to him; all men follow after him, and a countless throng goes before him.
- 34 "So how do you expect me to get any comfort from your nonsense? Your so-called comfort is a tissue of lies."
- 34 So how can you console me with your nonsense? Nothing is left of your answers but falsehood!

Job 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 Once again Eliphaz the Temanite took up his theme:
- 1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite replied:
- 2 "Are any of us strong enough to give God a hand, or smart enough to give him advice?
- 2 Can a man be of benefit to God? Can even a wise man benefit him?
- 3 So what if you were righteous--would God Almighty even notice? Even if you gave a perfect performance, do you think he'd applaud?

- 3 What pleasure would it give the Almighty if you were righteous? What would he gain if your ways were blameless?
- 4 Do you think it's because he cares about your purity that he's disciplining you, putting you on the spot?
- 4 Is it for your piety that he rebukes you and brings charges against you?
- 5 Hardly! It's because you're a first-class moral failure, because there's no end to your sins.
- 5 Is not your wickedness great? Are not your sins endless?
- 6 When people came to you for help, you took the shirts off their backs, exploited their helplessness.
- 6 You demanded security from your brothers for no reason; you stripped men of their clothing, leaving them naked.
- 7 You wouldn't so much as give a drink to the thirsty, or food, not even a scrap, to the hungry.
- 7 You gave no water to the weary and you withheld food from the hungry,
- 8 And there you sat, strong and honored by everyone, surrounded by immense wealth!
- 8 though you were a powerful man, owning land-- an honored man, living on it.
- 9 You turned poor widows away from your door; heartless, you crushed orphans.
- 9 And you sent widows away empty-handed and broke the strength of the fatherless.
- 10 Now you're the one trapped in terror, paralyzed by fear. Suddenly the tables have turned!
- 10 That is why snares are all around you, why sudden peril terrifies you,
- 11 How do you like living in the dark, sightless, up to your neck in flood waters?
- 11 why it is so dark you cannot see, and why a flood of water covers you.
- 12 "You agree, don't you, that God is in charge? He runs the universe--just look at the stars!
- 12 Is not God in the heights of heaven? And see how lofty are the highest stars!
- 13 Yet you dare raise questions: 'What does God know? From that distance and darkness, how can he judge?

- 13 Yet you say, 'What does God know? Does he judge through such darkness?
- 14 He roams the heavens wrapped in clouds, so how can he see us?'
- 14 Thick clouds veil him, so he does not see us as he goes about in the vaulted heavens.'
- 15 "Are you going to persist in that tired old line that wicked men and women have always used?
- 15 Will you keep to the old path that evil men have trod?
- 16 Where did it get them? They died young, flash floods sweeping them off to their doom.
- 16 They were carried off before their time, their foundations washed away by a flood.
- 17 They told God, 'Get lost! What good is God Almighty to us?'
- 17 They said to God, 'Leave us alone! What can the Almighty do to us?'
- 18 And yet it was God who gave them everything they had. It's beyond me how they can carry on like this!
- 18 Yet it was he who filled their houses with good things, so I stand aloof from the counsel of the wicked.
- 19 "Good people see bad people crash, and call for a celebration. Relieved, they crow,
- 19 The righteous see their ruin and rejoice; the innocent mock them, saying,
- 20 'At last! Our enemies--wiped out. Everything they had and stood for is up in smoke!'
- 20 'Surely our foes are destroyed, and fire devours their wealth.'
- 21 "Give in to God, come to terms with him and everything will turn out just fine.
- 21 Submit to God and be at peace with him; in this way prosperity will come to you.
- 22 Let him tell you what to do; take his words to heart.
- 22 Accept instruction from his mouth and lay up his words in your heart.
- 23 Come back to God Almighty and he'll rebuild your life. Clean house of everything evil.
- 23 If you return to the Almighty, you will be restored: If you remove wickedness far from your tent
- 24 Relax your grip on your money and abandon your gold-plated luxury.

24 and assign your nuggets to the dust, your gold of Ophir to the rocks in the ravines,
25 God Almighty will be your treasure, more wealth than you can imagine.
25 then the Almighty will be your gold, the choicest silver for you.
26 "You'll take delight in God, the Mighty One, and look to him joyfully, boldly.
26 Surely then you will find delight in the Almighty and will lift up your face to God.
27 You'll pray to him and he'll listen; he'll help you do what you've promised.
27 You will pray to him, and he will hear you, and you will fulfill your vows.
28 You'll decide what you want and it will happen; your life will be bathed in light.
28 What you decide on will be done, and light will shine on your ways.
29 To those who feel low you'll say, 'Chin up! Be brave!' and God will save them.
29 When men are brought low and you say, 'Lift them up!' then he will save the downcast.
30 Yes, even the guilty will escape, escape through God's grace in your life."
30 He will deliver even one who is not innocent, who will be delivered through the cleanness of your hands."

Job 23

MSG

NIV

1 Job replied:
1 Then Job replied:
2 "I'm not letting up--I'm standing my ground. My complaint is legitimate. God has no right to treat me like this-- it isn't fair!
2 Even today my complaint is bitter; his hand is heavy in spite of my groaning.
3 If I knew where on earth to find him, I'd go straight to him.
3 If only I knew where to find him; if only I could go to his dwelling!

- 4 I'd lay my case before him face-to-face, give him all my arguments firsthand.
- 4 I would state my case before him and fill my mouth with arguments.
- 5 I'd find out exactly what he's thinking, discover what's going on in his head.
- 5 I would find out what he would answer me, and consider what he would say.
- 6 Do you think he'd dismiss me or bully me? No, he'd take me seriously.
- 6 Would he oppose me with great power? No, he would not press charges against me.
- 7 He'd see a straight-living man standing before him; my Judge would acquit me for good of all charges.
- 7 There an upright man could present his case before him, and I would be delivered forever from my judge.
- 8 "I travel East looking for him--I find no one; then West, but not a trace;
- 8 But if I go to the east, he is not there; if I go to the west, I do not find him.
- 9 I go North, but he's hidden his tracks; then South, but not even a glimpse.
- 9 When he is at work in the north, I do not see him; when he turns to the south, I catch no glimpse of him.
- 10 "But he knows where I am and what I've done. He can cross-examine me all he wants, and I'll pass the test with honors.
- 10 But he knows the way that I take; when he has tested me, I will come forth as gold.
- 11 I've followed him closely, my feet in his footprints, not once swerving from his way.
- 11 My feet have closely followed his steps; I have kept to his way without turning aside.
- 12 I've obeyed every word he's spoken, and not just obeyed his advice--I've treasured it.
- 12 I have not departed from the commands of his lips; I have treasured the words of his mouth more than my daily bread.
- 13 "But he is singular and sovereign. Who can argue with him? He does what he wants, when he wants to.
- 13 But he stands alone, and who can oppose him? He does whatever he pleases.

- 14 He'll complete in detail what he's decided about me, and whatever else he determines to do.
- 14 He carries out his decree against me, and many such plans he still has in store.
- 15 Is it any wonder that I dread meeting him? Whenever I think about it, I get scared all over again.
- 15 That is why I am terrified before him; when I think of all this, I fear him.
- 16 God makes my heart sink! God Almighty gives me the shudders!
- 16 God has made my heart faint; the Almighty has terrified me.
- 17 I'm completely in the dark, I can't see my hand in front of my face.
- 17 Yet I am not silenced by the darkness, by the thick darkness that covers my face.

Job 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 "But if Judgment Day isn't hidden from the Almighty, why are we kept in the dark?
- 1 Why does the Almighty not set times for judgment? Why must those who know him look in vain for such days?
- 2 There are people out there getting by with murder-- stealing and lying and cheating.
- 2 Men move boundary stones; they pasture flocks they have stolen.
- 3 They rip off the poor and exploit the unfortunate,
- 3 They drive away the orphan's donkey and take the widow's ox in pledge.
- 4 Push the helpless into the ditch, bully the weak so that they fear for their lives.
- 4 They thrust the needy from the path and force all the poor of the land into hiding.
- 5 The poor, like stray dogs and cats, scavenge for food in back alleys.
- 5 Like wild donkeys in the desert, the poor go about their labor of foraging food; the wasteland provides food for their children.
- 6 They sort through the garbage of the rich, eke out survival on handouts.
- 6 They gather fodder in the fields and glean in the vineyards of the wicked.

- 7 Homeless, they shiver through cold nights on the street; they've no place to lay their heads.
- 7 Lacking clothes, they spend the night naked; they have nothing to cover themselves in the cold.
- 8 Exposed to the weather, wet and frozen, they huddle in makeshift shelters.
- 8 They are drenched by mountain rains and hug the rocks for lack of shelter.
- 9 Nursing mothers have their babies snatched from them; the infants of the poor are kidnapped and sold.
- 9 The fatherless child is snatched from the breast; the infant of the poor is seized for a debt.
- 10 They go about patched and threadbare; even the hard workers go hungry.
- 10 Lacking clothes, they go about naked; they carry the sheaves, but still go hungry.
- 11 No matter how back-breaking their labor, they can never make ends meet.
- 11 They crush olives among the terraces; they tread the winepresses, yet suffer thirst.
- 12 People are dying right and left, groaning in torment. The wretched cry out for help and God does nothing, acts like nothing's wrong!
- 12 The groans of the dying rise from the city, and the souls of the wounded cry out for help. But God charges no one with wrongdoing.
- 13 "Then there are those who avoid light at all costs, who scorn the light-filled path.
- 13 There are those who rebel against the light, who do not know its ways or stay in its paths.
- 14 When the sun goes down, the murderer gets up-- kills the poor and robs the defenseless.
- 14 When daylight is gone, the murderer rises up and kills the poor and needy; in the night he steals forth like a thief.
- 15 Sexual predators can't wait for nightfall, thinking, 'No one can see us now.'
- 15 The eye of the adulterer watches for dusk; he thinks, 'No eye will see me,' and he keeps his face concealed.

- 16 Burglars do their work at night, but keep well out of sight through the day. They want nothing to do with light.
- 16 In the dark, men break into houses, but by day they shut themselves in; they want nothing to do with the light.
- 17 Deep darkness is morning for that bunch; they make the terrors of darkness their companions in crime.
- 17 For all of them, deep darkness is their morning; they make friends with the terrors of darkness.
- 18 "They are scraps of wood floating on the water-- useless, cursed junk, good for nothing.
- 18 Yet they are foam on the surface of the water; their portion of the land is cursed, so that no one goes to the vineyards.
- 19 As surely as snow melts under the hot, summer sun, sinners disappear in the grave.
- 19 As heat and drought snatch away the melted snow, so the grave snatches away those who have sinned.
- 20 The womb has forgotten them, worms have relished them-- nothing that is evil lasts.
- 20 The womb forgets them, the worm feasts on them; evil men are no longer remembered but are broken like a tree.
- 21 Unscrupulous, they prey on those less fortunate.
- 21 They prey on the barren and childless woman, and to the widow show no kindness.
- 22 However much they strut and flex their muscles, there's nothing to them. They're hollow.
- 22 But God drags away the mighty by his power; though they become established, they have no assurance of life.
- 23 They may have an illusion of security, but God has his eye on them.
- 23 He may let them rest in a feeling of security, but his eyes are on their ways.
- 24 They may get their brief successes, but then it's over, nothing to show for it. Like yesterday's newspaper, they're used to wrap up the garbage.
- 24 For a little while they are exalted, and then they are gone; they are brought low and gathered up like all others; they are cut off like heads of grain.
- 25 You're free to try to prove me a liar, but you won't be able to do it."

25 If this is not so, who can prove me false and reduce my words to nothing?

Job 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 Bildad the Shuhite again attacked Job:
- 1 Then Bildad the Shuhite replied:
- 2 "God is sovereign, God is fearsome-- everything in the cosmos fits and works in his plan.
- 2 Dominion and awe belong to God; he establishes order in the heights of heaven.
- 3 Can anyone count his angel armies? Is there any place where his light doesn't shine?
- 3 Can his forces be numbered? Upon whom does his light not rise?
- 4 How can a mere mortal presume to stand up to God? How can an ordinary person pretend to be guiltless?
- 4 How then can a man be righteous before God? How can one born of woman be pure?
- 5 Why, even the moon has its flaws, even the stars aren't perfect in God's eyes,
- 5 If even the moon is not bright and the stars are not pure in his eyes,
- 6 So how much less, plain men and women-- slugs and maggots by comparison!"
- 6 how much less man, who is but a maggot-- a son of man, who is only a worm!"

Job 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job answered:
- 1 Then Job replied:
- 2 "Well, you've certainly been a great help to a helpless man! You came to the rescue just in the nick of time!

- 2 How you have helped the powerless! How you have saved the arm that is feeble!
- 3 What wonderful advice you've given to a mixed-up man! What amazing insights you've provided!
- 3 What advice you have offered to one without wisdom! And what great insight you have displayed!
- 4 Where in the world did you learn all this? How did you become so inspired?
- 4 Who has helped you utter these words? And whose spirit spoke from your mouth?
- 5 "All the buried dead are in torment, and all who've been drowned in the deep, deep sea.
- 5 The dead are in deep anguish, those beneath the waters and all that live in them.
- 6 Hell is ripped open before God, graveyards dug up and exposed.
- 6 Death is naked before God; Destruction lies uncovered.
- 7 He spreads the skies over unformed space, hangs the earth out in empty space.
- 7 He spreads out the northern skies over empty space; he suspends the earth over nothing.
- 8 He pours water into cumulus cloud-bags and the bags don't burst.
- 8 He wraps up the waters in his clouds, yet the clouds do not burst under their weight.
- 9 He makes the moon wax and wane, putting it through its phases.
- 9 He covers the face of the full moon, spreading his clouds over it.
- 10 He draws the horizon out over the ocean, sets a boundary between light and darkness.
- 10 He marks out the horizon on the face of the waters for a boundary between light and darkness.
- 11 Thunder crashes and rumbles in the skies. Listen! It's God raising his voice!
- 11 The pillars of the heavens quake, aghast at his rebuke.
- 12 By his power he stills sea storms, by his wisdom he tames sea monsters.
- 12 By his power he churned up the sea; by his wisdom he cut Rahab to pieces.

13 With one breath he clears the sky, with one finger he crushes the sea serpent.

13 By his breath the skies became fair; his hand pierced the gliding serpent.

14 And this is only the beginning, a mere whisper of his rule. Whatever would we do if he really raised his voice!"

14 And these are but the outer fringe of his works; how faint the whisper we hear of him! Who then can understand the thunder of his power?"

Job 27

MSG

NIV

1 Having waited for Zophar, Job now resumed his defense:

1 And Job continued his discourse:

2 "God-Alive! He's denied me justice! God Almighty! He's ruined my life!

2 As surely as God lives, who has denied me justice, the Almighty, who has made me taste bitterness of soul,

3 But for as long as I draw breath, and for as long as God breathes life into me,

3 as long as I have life within me, the breath of God in my nostrils,

4 I refuse to say one word that isn't true. I refuse to confess to any charge that's false.

4 my lips will not speak wickedness, and my tongue will utter no deceit.

5 There is no way I'll ever agree to your accusations. I'll not deny my integrity even if it costs me my life.

5 I will never admit you are in the right; till I die, I will not deny my integrity.

6 I'm holding fast to my integrity and not loosening my grip-- and, believe me, I'll never regret it.

6 I will maintain my righteousness and never let go of it; my conscience will not reproach me as long as I live.

7 "Let my enemy be exposed as wicked! Let my adversary be proven guilty!

7 May my enemies be like the wicked, my adversaries like the unjust!

8 What hope do people without God have when life is cut short? when God puts an end to life?

- 8 For what hope has the godless when he is cut off, when God takes away his life?
- 9 Do you think God will listen to their cry for help when disaster hits?
- 9 Does God listen to his cry when distress comes upon him?
- 10 What interest have they ever shown in the Almighty? Have they ever been known to pray before?
- 10 Will he find delight in the Almighty? Will he call upon God at all times?
- 11 "I've given you a clear account of God in action, suppressed nothing regarding God Almighty.
- 11 I will teach you about the power of God; the ways of the Almighty I will not conceal.
- 12 The evidence is right before you. You can all see it for yourselves, so why do you keep talking nonsense?
- 12 You have all seen this yourselves. Why then this meaningless talk?
- 13 "I'll quote your own words back to you: "'This is how God treats the wicked, this is what evil people can expect from God Almighty:
- 13 Here is the fate God allots to the wicked, the heritage a ruthless man receives from the Almighty:
- 14 Their children--all of them--will die violent deaths; they'll never have enough bread to put on the table.
- 14 However many his children, their fate is the sword; his offspring will never have enough to eat.
- 15 They'll be wiped out by the plague, and none of the widows will shed a tear when they're gone.
- 15 The plague will bury those who survive him, and their widows will not weep for them.
- 16 Even if they make a lot of money and are resplendent in the latest fashions,
- 16 Though he heaps up silver like dust and clothes like piles of clay,
- 17 It's the good who will end up wearing the clothes and the decent who will divide up the money.
- 17 what he lays up the righteous will wear, and the innocent will divide his silver.
- 18 They build elaborate houses that won't survive a single winter.
- 18 The house he builds is like a moth's cocoon, like a hut made by a watchman.

- 19 They go to bed wealthy and wake up poor.
19 He lies down wealthy, but will do so no more; when he opens his eyes,
all is gone.
20 Terrors pour in on them like flash floods-- a tornado snatches them
away in the middle of the night,
20 Terrors overtake him like a flood; a tempest snatches him away in the
night.
21 A cyclone sweeps them up--gone! Not a trace of them left, not even a
footprint.
21 The east wind carries him off, and he is gone; it sweeps him out of his
place.
22 Catastrophes relentlessly pursue them; they run this way and that, but
there's no place to hide--
22 It hurls itself against him without mercy as he flees headlong from its
power.
23 Pummeled by the weather, blown to kingdom come by the storm.'
23 It claps its hands in derision and hisses him out of his place.

Job 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 "We all know how silver seams the rocks, we've seen the stuff from
which gold is refined,
1 There is a mine for silver and a place where gold is refined.
2 We're aware of how iron is dug out of the ground and copper is smelted
from rock.
2 Iron is taken from the earth, and copper is smelted from ore.
3 Miners penetrate the earth's darkness, searching the roots of the
mountains for ore, digging away in the suffocating darkness.
3 Man puts an end to the darkness; he searches the farthest recesses for ore
in the blackest darkness.
4 Far from civilization, far from the traffic, they cut a shaft, and are
lowered into it by ropes.
4 Far from where people dwell he cuts a shaft, in places forgotten by the
foot of man; far from men he dangles and sways.

5 Earth's surface is a field for grain, but its depths are a forge
5 The earth, from which food comes, is transformed below as by fire;
6 Firing sapphires from stones and chiseling gold from rocks.
6 sapphires come from its rocks, and its dust contains nuggets of gold.
7 Vultures are blind to its riches, hawks never lay eyes on it.
7 No bird of prey knows that hidden path, no falcon's eye has seen it.
8 Wild animals are oblivious to it, lions don't know it's there.
8 Proud beasts do not set foot on it, and no lion prowls there.
9 Miners hammer away at the rock, they uproot the mountains.
9 Man's hand assaults the flinty rock and lays bare the roots of the mountains.
10 They tunnel through the rock and find all kinds of beautiful gems.
10 He tunnels through the rock; his eyes see all its treasures.
11 They discover the origins of rivers, and bring earth's secrets to light.
11 He searches the sources of the rivers and brings hidden things to light.
12 "But where, oh where, will they find Wisdom? Where does Insight hide?
12 But where can wisdom be found? Where does understanding dwell?
13 Mortals don't have a clue, haven't the slightest idea where to look.
13 Man does not comprehend its worth; it cannot be found in the land of the living.
14 Earth's depths say, 'It's not here'; ocean deeps echo, 'Never heard of it.'
14 The deep says, 'It is not in me'; the sea says, 'It is not with me.'
15 It can't be bought with the finest gold; no amount of silver can get it.
15 It cannot be bought with the finest gold, nor can its price be weighed in silver.
16 Even famous Ophir gold can't buy it, not even diamonds and sapphires.
16 It cannot be bought with the gold of Ophir, with precious onyx or sapphires.
17 Neither gold nor emeralds are comparable; extravagant jewelry can't touch it.
17 Neither gold nor crystal can compare with it, nor can it be had for jewels of gold.
18 Pearl necklaces and ruby bracelets--why bother? None of this is even a down payment on Wisdom!

18 Coral and jasper are not worthy of mention; the price of wisdom is beyond rubies.

19 Pile gold and African diamonds as high as you will, they can't hold a candle to Wisdom.

19 The topaz of Cush cannot compare with it; it cannot be bought with pure gold.

20 "So where does Wisdom come from? And where does Insight live?

20 Where then does wisdom come from? Where does understanding dwell?

21 It can't be found by looking, no matter how deep you dig, no matter how high you fly.

21 It is hidden from the eyes of every living thing, concealed even from the birds of the air.

22 If you search through the graveyard and question the dead, they say, 'We've only heard rumors of it.'

22 Destruction and Death say, 'Only a rumor of it has reached our ears.'

23 "God alone knows the way to Wisdom, he knows the exact place to find it.

23 God understands the way to it and he alone knows where it dwells,

24 He knows where everything is on earth, he sees everything under heaven.

24 for he views the ends of the earth and sees everything under the heavens.

25 After he commanded the winds to blow and measured out the waters,

25 When he established the force of the wind and measured out the waters,

26 Arranged for the rain and set off explosions of thunder and lightning,

26 when he made a decree for the rain and a path for the thunderstorm,

27 He focused on Wisdom, made sure it was all set and tested and ready.

27 then he looked at wisdom and appraised it; he confirmed it and tested it.

28 Then he addressed the human race: 'Here it is! Fear-of-the-Lord--that's Wisdom, and Insight means shunning evil.'

28 And he said to man, 'The fear of the Lord--that is wisdom, and to shun evil is understanding.' "

Job 29

MSG

NIV

1 Job now resumed his response:

1 Job continued his discourse:

2 "Oh, how I long for the good old days, when God took such very good care of me.

2 How I long for the months gone by, for the days when God watched over me,

3 He always held a lamp before me and I walked through the dark by its light.

3 when his lamp shone upon my head and by his light I walked through darkness!

4 Oh, how I miss those golden years when God's friendship graced my home,

4 Oh, for the days when I was in my prime, when God's intimate friendship blessed my house,

5 When the Mighty One was still by my side and my children were all around me,

5 when the Almighty was still with me and my children were around me,

6 When everything was going my way, and nothing seemed too difficult.

6 when my path was drenched with cream and the rock poured out for me streams of olive oil.

7 "When I walked downtown and sat with my friends in the public square,

7 When I went to the gate of the city and took my seat in the public square,

8 Young and old greeted me with respect; I was honored by everyone in town.

8 the young men saw me and stepped aside and the old men rose to their feet;

9 When I spoke, everyone listened;

9 the chief men refrained from speaking and covered their mouths with their hands;

10 they hung on my every word.

10 the voices of the nobles were hushed, and their tongues stuck to the roof of their mouths.

11 People who knew me spoke well of me; my reputation went ahead of me.

11 Whoever heard me spoke well of me, and those who saw me
commended me,
12 I was known for helping people in trouble and standing up for those
who were down on their luck.
12 because I rescued the poor who cried for help, and the fatherless who
had none to assist him.
13 The dying blessed me, and the bereaved were cheered by my visits.
13 The man who was dying blessed me; I made the widow's heart sing.
14 All my dealings with people were good. I was known for being fair to
everyone I met.
14 I put on righteousness as my clothing; justice was my robe and my
turban.
15 I was eyes to the blind and feet to the lame,
15 I was eyes to the blind and feet to the lame.
16 Father to the needy, and champion of abused aliens.
16 I was a father to the needy; I took up the case of the stranger.
17 I grabbed street thieves by the scruff of the neck and made them give
back what they'd stolen.
17 I broke the fangs of the wicked and snatched the victims from their
teeth.
18 I thought, 'I'll die peacefully in my own bed, grateful for a long and full
life,
18 I thought, 'I will die in my own house, my days as numerous as the
grains of sand.
19 A life deep-rooted and well-watered, a life limber and dew-fresh,
19 My roots will reach to the water, and the dew will lie all night on my
branches.
20 My soul suffused with glory and my body robust until the day I die.'
20 My glory will remain fresh in me, the bow ever new in my hand.'
21 "Men and women listened when I spoke, hung expectantly on my every
word.
21 Men listened to me expectantly, waiting in silence for my counsel.
22 After I spoke, they'd be quiet, taking it all in.
22 After I had spoken, they spoke no more; my words fell gently on their
ears.
23 They welcomed my counsel like spring rain, drinking it all in.

- 23 They waited for me as for showers and drank in my words as the spring rain.
- 24 When I smiled at them, they could hardly believe it; their faces lit up, their troubles took wing!
- 24 When I smiled at them, they scarcely believed it; the light of my face was precious to them.
- 25 I was their leader, establishing the mood and setting the pace by which they lived. Where I led, they followed.
- 25 I chose the way for them and sat as their chief; I dwelt as a king among his troops; I was like one who comforts mourners.

Job 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 "But no longer. Now I'm the butt of their jokes-- young ruffians! whippersnappers!
- 1 But now they mock me, men younger than I, whose fathers I would have disdained to put with my sheep dogs.
- 2 Why, I considered their fathers mere inexperienced pups. But they are worse than dogs--good for nothing, stray, mangy animals,
- 2 Of what use was the strength of their hands to me, since their vigor had gone from them?
- 3 Half-starved, scavenging the back alleys, howling at the moon;
- 3 Haggard from want and hunger, they roamed the parched land in desolate wastelands at night.
- 4 Homeless guttersnipes chewing on old bones and licking old tin cans;
- 4 In the brush they gathered salt herbs, and their food was the root of the broom tree.
- 5 Outcasts from the community, cursed as dangerous delinquents.
- 5 They were banished from their fellow men, shouted at as if they were thieves.
- 6 Nobody would put up with them; they were driven from the neighborhood.
- 6 They were forced to live in the dry stream beds, among the rocks and in holes in the ground.

7 You could hear them out there at the edge of town, yelping and barking,
huddled in junkyards,
7 They brayed among the bushes and huddled in the undergrowth.
8 A gang of beggars and no-names, thrown out on their ears.
8 A base and nameless brood, they were driven out of the land.
9 "But now I'm the one they're after, mistreating me, taunting and mocking.
9 And now their sons mock me in song; I have become a byword among
them.
10 They abhor me, they abuse me. How dare those scoundrels--they spit in
my face!
10 They detest me and keep their distance; they do not hesitate to spit in
my face.
11 Now that God has undone me and left me in a heap, they hold nothing
back. Anything goes.
11 Now that God has unstrung my bow and afflicted me, they throw off
restraint in my presence.
12 They come at me from my blind side, trip me up, then jump on me
while I'm down.
12 On my right the tribe attacks; they lay snares for my feet, they build
their siege ramps against me.
13 They throw every kind of obstacle in my path, determined to ruin me--
and no one lifts a finger to help me!
13 They break up my road; they succeed in destroying me-- without
anyone's helping them.
14 They violate my broken body, trample through the rubble of my ruined
life.
14 They advance as through a gaping breach; amid the ruins they come
rolling in.
15 Terrors assault me-- my dignity in shreds, salvation up in smoke.
15 Terrors overwhelm me; my dignity is driven away as by the wind, my
safety vanishes like a cloud.
16 "And now my life drains out, as suffering seizes and grips me hard.
16 And now my life ebbs away; days of suffering grip me.
17 Night gnaws at my bones; the pain never lets up.
17 Night pierces my bones; my gnawing pains never rest.
18 I am tied hand and foot, my neck in a noose. I twist and turn.

18 In his great power God becomes like clothing to me; he binds me like the neck of my garment.

19 Thrown facedown in the muck, I'm a muddy mess, inside and out.

19 He throws me into the mud, and I am reduced to dust and ashes.

20 "I shout for help, God, and get nothing, no answer! I stand to face you in protest, and you give me a blank stare!

20 I cry out to you, O God, but you do not answer; I stand up, but you merely look at me.

21 You've turned into my tormenter-- you slap me around, knock me about.

21 You turn on me ruthlessly; with the might of your hand you attack me.

22 You raised me up so I was riding high and then dropped me, and I crashed.

22 You snatch me up and drive me before the wind; you toss me about in the storm.

23 I know you're determined to kill me, to put me six feet under.

23 I know you will bring me down to death, to the place appointed for all the living.

24 "What did I do to deserve this? Did I ever hit anyone who was calling for help?

24 Surely no one lays a hand on a broken man when he cries for help in his distress.

25 Haven't I wept for those who live a hard life, been heartsick over the lot of the poor?

25 Have I not wept for those in trouble? Has not my soul grieved for the poor?

26 But where did it get me? I expected good but evil showed up. I looked for light but darkness fell.

26 Yet when I hoped for good, evil came; when I looked for light, then came darkness.

27 My stomach's in a constant churning, never settles down. Each day confronts me with more suffering.

27 The churning inside me never stops; days of suffering confront me.

28 I walk under a black cloud. The sun is gone. I stand in the congregation and protest.

28 I go about blackened, but not by the sun; I stand up in the assembly and cry for help.

29 I howl with the jackals, I hoot with the owls.
29 I have become a brother of jackals, a companion of owls.
30 I'm black and blue all over, burning up with fever.
30 My skin grows black and peels; my body burns with fever.
31 My fiddle plays nothing but the blues; my mouth harp wails laments.
31 My harp is tuned to mourning, and my flute to the sound of wailing.

Job 31

MSG

NIV

1 "I made a solemn pact with myself never to undress a girl with my eyes.
1 I made a covenant with my eyes not to look lustfully at a girl.
2 So what can I expect from God? What do I deserve from God Almighty above?
2 For what is man's lot from God above, his heritage from the Almighty on high?
3 Isn't calamity reserved for the wicked? Isn't disaster supposed to strike those who do wrong?
3 Is it not ruin for the wicked, disaster for those who do wrong?
4 Isn't God looking, observing how I live? Doesn't he mark every step I take?
4 Does he not see my ways and count my every step?
5 "Have I walked hand in hand with falsehood, or hung out in the company of deceit?
5 If I have walked in falsehood or my foot has hurried after deceit--
6 Weigh me on a set of honest scales so God has proof of my integrity.
6 let God weigh me in honest scales and he will know that I am blameless--
7 If I've strayed off the straight and narrow, wanted things I had no right to, messed around with sin,
7 if my steps have turned from the path, if my heart has been led by my eyes, or if my hands have been defiled,
8 Go ahead, then-- give my portion to someone who deserves it.
8 then may others eat what I have sown, and may my crops be uprooted.
9 "If I've let myself be seduced by a woman and conspired to go to bed with her,

9 If my heart has been enticed by a woman, or if I have lurked at my neighbor's door,
10 Fine, my wife has every right to go ahead and sleep with anyone she wants to.
10 then may my wife grind another man's grain, and may other men sleep with her.
11 For disgusting behavior like that, I'd deserve the worst punishment you could hand out.
11 For that would have been shameful, a sin to be judged.
12 Adultery is a fire that burns the house down; I wouldn't expect anything I count dear to survive it.
12 It is a fire that burns to Destruction; it would have uprooted my harvest.
13 "Have I ever been unfair to my employees when they brought a complaint to me?
13 If I have denied justice to my menservants and maidservants when they had a grievance against me,
14 What, then, will I do when God confronts me? When God examines my books, what can I say?
14 what will I do when God confronts me? What will I answer when called to account?
15 Didn't the same God who made me, make them? Aren't we all made of the same stuff, equals before God?
15 Did not he who made me in the womb make them? Did not the same one form us both within our mothers?
16 "Have I ignored the needs of the poor, turned my back on the indigent,
16 If I have denied the desires of the poor or let the eyes of the widow grow weary,
17 Taken care of my own needs and fed my own face while they languished?
17 if I have kept my bread to myself, not sharing it with the fatherless--
18 Wasn't my home always open to them? Weren't they always welcome at my table?
18 but from my youth I reared him as would a father, and from my birth I guided the widow--
19 "Have I ever left a poor family shivering in the cold when they had no warm clothes?

19 if I have seen anyone perishing for lack of clothing, or a needy man
without a garment,
20 Didn't the poor bless me when they saw me coming, knowing I'd
brought coats from my closet?
20 and his heart did not bless me for warming him with the fleece from my
sheep,
21 "If I've ever used my strength and influence to take advantage of the
unfortunate,
21 if I have raised my hand against the fatherless, knowing that I had
influence in court,
22 Go ahead, break both my arms, cut off all my fingers!
22 then let my arm fall from the shoulder, let it be broken off at the joint.
23 The fear of God has kept me from these things-- how else could I ever
face him? If Only Someone Would Give Me a Hearing!
23 For I dreaded destruction from God, and for fear of his splendor I could
not do such things.
24 "Did I set my heart on making big money or worship at the bank?
24 If I have put my trust in gold or said to pure gold, 'You are my security,'
25 Did I boast about my wealth, show off because I was well-off?
25 if I have rejoiced over my great wealth, the fortune my hands had
gained,
26 Was I ever so awed by the sun's brilliance and moved by the moon's
beauty
26 if I have regarded the sun in its radiance or the moon moving in
splendor,
27 That I let myself become seduced by them and worshiped them on the
sly?
27 so that my heart was secretly enticed and my hand offered them a kiss
of homage,
28 If so, I would deserve the worst of punishments, for I would be
betraying God himself.
28 then these also would be sins to be judged, for I would have been
unfaithful to God on high.
29 "Did I ever crow over my enemy's ruin? Or gloat over my rival's bad
luck?

29 If I have rejoiced at my enemy's misfortune or gloated over the trouble that came to him--

30 No, I never said a word of detraction, never cursed them, even under my breath.

30 I have not allowed my mouth to sin by invoking a curse against his life--

31 "Didn't those who worked for me say, 'He fed us well. There were always second helpings'?

31 if the men of my household have never said, 'Who has not had his fill of Job's meat?'--

32 And no stranger ever had to spend a night in the street; my doors were always open to travelers.

32 but no stranger had to spend the night in the street, for my door was always open to the traveler--

33 Did I hide my sin the way Adam did, or conceal my guilt behind closed doors

33 if I have concealed my sin as men do, by hiding my guilt in my heart

34 Because I was afraid what people would say, fearing the gossip of the neighbors so much That I turned myself into a recluse? You know good and well that I didn't.

34 because I so feared the crowd and so dreaded the contempt of the clans that I kept silent and would not go outside

35 "Oh, if only someone would give me a hearing! I've signed my name to my defense--let the Almighty One answer! I want to see my indictment in writing.

35 ("Oh, that I had someone to hear me! I sign now my defense--let the Almighty answer me; let my accuser put his indictment in writing.

36 Anyone's welcome to read my defense; I'll write it on a poster and carry it around town.

36 Surely I would wear it on my shoulder, I would put it on like a crown.

37 I'm prepared to account for every move I've ever made-- to anyone and everyone, prince or pauper.

37 I would give him an account of my every step; like a prince I would approach him.)--

38 "If the very ground that I farm accuses me, if even the furrows fill with tears from my abuse,

38 if my land cries out against me and all its furrows are wet with tears,
39 If I've ever raped the earth for my own profit or dispossessed its rightful owners,
39 if I have devoured its yield without payment or broken the spirit of its tenants,
40 Then curse it with thistles instead of wheat, curse it with weeds instead of barley." The words of Job to his three friends were finished.
40 then let briars come up instead of wheat and weeds instead of barley."
The words of Job are ended.

Job 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job's three friends now fell silent. They were talked out, stymied because Job wouldn't budge an inch--wouldn't admit to an ounce of guilt.
- 1 So these three men stopped answering Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes.
- 2 Then Elihu lost his temper. (Elihu was the son of Barakel the Buzite from the clan of Ram.) He blazed out in anger against Job for pitting his righteousness against God's.
- 2 But Elihu son of Barakel the Buzite, of the family of Ram, became very angry with Job for justifying himself rather than God.
- 3 He was also angry with the three friends because they had neither come up with an answer nor proved Job wrong.
- 3 He was also angry with the three friends, because they had found no way to refute Job, and yet had condemned him.
- 4 Elihu had waited with Job while they spoke because they were all older than he.
- 4 Now Elihu had waited before speaking to Job because they were older than he.
- 5 But when he saw that the three other men had exhausted their arguments, he exploded with pent-up anger.
- 5 But when he saw that the three men had nothing more to say, his anger was aroused.

- 6 This is what Elihu, son of Barakel the Buzite, said: "I'm a young man, and you are all old and experienced. That's why I kept quiet and held back from joining the discussion.
- 6 So Elihu son of Barakel the Buzite said: "I am young in years, and you are old; that is why I was fearful, not daring to tell you what I know.
- 7 I kept thinking, 'Experience will tell. The longer you live, the wiser you become.'
- 7 I thought, 'Age should speak; advanced years should teach wisdom.'
- 8 But I see I was wrong--it's God's Spirit in a person, the breath of the Almighty One, that makes wise human insight possible.
- 8 But it is the spirit in a man, the breath of the Almighty, that gives him understanding.
- 9 The experts have no corner on wisdom; getting old doesn't guarantee good sense.
- 9 It is not only the old who are wise, not only the aged who understand what is right.
- 10 So I've decided to speak up. Listen well! I'm going to tell you exactly what I think.
- 10 Therefore I say: Listen to me; I too will tell you what I know.
- 11 "I hung on your words while you spoke, listened carefully to your arguments. While you searched for the right words,
- 11 I waited while you spoke, I listened to your reasoning; while you were searching for words,
- 12 I was all ears. And now what have you proved? Nothing. Nothing you say has even touched Job.
- 12 I gave you my full attention. But not one of you has proved Job wrong; none of you has answered his arguments.
- 13 And don't excuse yourselves by saying, 'We've done our best. Now it's up to God to talk sense into him.'
- 13 Do not say, 'We have found wisdom; let God refute him, not man.'
- 14 Job has yet to contend with me. And rest assured, I won't be using your arguments!
- 14 But Job has not marshaled his words against me, and I will not answer him with your arguments.
- 15 "Do you three have nothing else to say? Of course you don't! You're total frauds!

15 They are dismayed and have no more to say; words have failed them.
16 Why should I wait any longer, now that you're stopped dead in your tracks?
16 Must I wait, now that they are silent, now that they stand there with no reply?
17 I'm ready to speak my piece. That's right! It's my turn--and it's about time!
17 I too will have my say; I too will tell what I know.
18 I've got a lot to say, and I'm bursting to say it.
18 For I am full of words, and the spirit within me compels me;
19 The pressure has built up, like lava beneath the earth. I'm a volcano ready to blow.
19 inside I am like bottled-up wine, like new wineskins ready to burst.
20 I have to speak--I have no choice. I have to say what's on my heart,
20 I must speak and find relief; I must open my lips and reply.
21 And I'm going to say it straight-- the truth, the whole truth, and nothing but the truth.
21 I will show partiality to no one, nor will I flatter any man;
22 I was never any good at bootlicking; my Maker would make short work of me if I started in now!
22 for if I were skilled in flattery, my Maker would soon take me away.

Job 33

MSG

NIV

1 "So please, Job, hear me out, honor me by listening to me.
1 But now, Job, listen to my words; pay attention to everything I say.
2 What I'm about to say has been carefully thought out.
2 I am about to open my mouth; my words are on the tip of my tongue.
3 I have no ulterior motives in this; I'm speaking honestly from my heart.
3 My words come from an upright heart; my lips sincerely speak what I know.
4 The Spirit of God made me what I am, the breath of God Almighty gave me life!
4 The Spirit of God has made me; the breath of the Almighty gives me life.

5 "And if you think you can prove me wrong, do it. Lay out your arguments. Stand up for yourself!

5 Answer me then, if you can; prepare yourself and confront me.

6 Look, I'm human--no better than you; we're both made of the same kind of mud.

6 I am just like you before God; I too have been taken from clay.

7 So let's work this through together; don't let my aggressiveness overwhelm you.

7 No fear of me should alarm you, nor should my hand be heavy upon you.

8 "Here's what you said. I heard you say it with my own ears.

8 But you have said in my hearing-- I heard the very words--

9 You said, 'I'm pure--I've done nothing wrong. Believe me, I'm clean--my conscience is clear.

9 'I am pure and without sin; I am clean and free from guilt.

10 But God keeps picking on me; he treats me like I'm his enemy.

10 Yet God has found fault with me; he considers me his enemy.

11 He's thrown me in jail; he keeps me under constant surveillance.'

11 He fastens my feet in shackles; he keeps close watch on all my paths.'

12 "But let me tell you, Job, you're wrong, dead wrong! God is far greater than any human.

12 But I tell you, in this you are not right, for God is greater than man.

13 So how dare you haul him into court, and then complain that he won't answer your charges?

13 Why do you complain to him that he answers none of man's words?

14 God always answers, one way or another, even when people don't recognize his presence.

14 For God does speak--now one way, now another-- though man may not perceive it.

15 "In a dream, for instance, a vision at night, when men and women are deep in sleep, fast asleep in their beds--

15 In a dream, in a vision of the night, when deep sleep falls on men as they slumber in their beds,

16 God opens their ears and impresses them with warnings

16 he may speak in their ears and terrify them with warnings,

17 To turn them back from something bad they're planning, from some reckless choice,

17 to turn man from wrongdoing and keep him from pride,
18 And keep them from an early grave, from the river of no return.
18 to preserve his soul from the pit, his life from perishing by the sword.
19 "Or, God might get their attention through pain, by throwing them on a
bed of suffering,
19 Or a man may be chastened on a bed of pain with constant distress in
his bones,
20 So they can't stand the sight of food, have no appetite for their favorite
treats.
20 so that his very being finds food repulsive and his soul loathes the
choicest meal.
21 They lose weight, wasting away to nothing, reduced to a bag of bones.
21 His flesh wastes away to nothing, and his bones, once hidden, now stick
out.
22 They hang on the cliff-edge of death, knowing the next breath may be
their last.
22 His soul draws near to the pit, and his life to the messengers of death.
23 "But even then an angel could come, a champion--there are thousands
of them!-- to take up your cause,
23 Yet if there is an angel on his side as a mediator, one out of a thousand,
to tell a man what is right for him,
24 A messenger who would mercifully intervene, canceling the death
sentence with the words: 'I've come up with the ransom!'
24 to be gracious to him and say, 'Spare him from going down to the pit; I
have found a ransom for him'--
25 Before you know it, you're healed, the very picture of health!
25 then his flesh is renewed like a child's; it is restored as in the days of his
youth.
26 "Or, you may fall on your knees and pray--to God's delight! You'll see
God's smile and celebrate, finding yourself set right with God.
26 He prays to God and finds favor with him, he sees God's face and shouts
for joy; he is restored by God to his righteous state.
27 You'll sing God's praises to everyone you meet, testifying, 'I messed up
my life-- and let me tell you, it wasn't worth it.
27 Then he comes to men and says, 'I sinned, and perverted what was right,
but I did not get what I deserved.

28 But God stepped in and saved me from certain death. I'm alive again!
Once more I see the light!

28 He redeemed my soul from going down to the pit, and I will live to
enjoy the light.'

29 "This is the way God works. Over and over again
29 God does all these things to a man-- twice, even three times--
30 He pulls our souls back from certain destruction so we'll see the light--
and live in the light!

30 to turn back his soul from the pit, that the light of life may shine on him.

31 "Keep listening, Job. Don't interrupt--I'm not finished yet.
31 Pay attention, Job, and listen to me; be silent, and I will speak.

32 But if you think of anything I should know, tell me. There's nothing I'd
like better than to see your name cleared.

32 If you have anything to say, answer me; speak up, for I want you to be
cleared.

33 Meanwhile, keep listening. Don't distract me with interruptions. I'm
going to teach you the basics of wisdom."

33 But if not, then listen to me; be silent, and I will teach you wisdom."

Job 34

MSG

NIV

1 Elihu continued:
1 Then Elihu said:
2 "So, my fine friends--listen to me, and see what you think of this.
2 Hear my words, you wise men; listen to me, you men of learning.
3 Isn't it just common sense-- as common as the sense of taste--
3 For the ear tests words as the tongue tastes food.
4 To put our heads together and figure out what's going on here?
4 Let us discern for ourselves what is right; let us learn together what is
good.
5 "We've all heard Job say, 'I'm in the right, but God won't give me a fair
trial.
5 Job says, 'I am innocent, but God denies me justice.

6 When I defend myself, I'm called a liar to my face. I've done nothing wrong, and I get punished anyway.'

6 Although I am right, I am considered a liar; although I am guiltless, his arrow inflicts an incurable wound.'

7 Have you ever heard anything to beat this? Does nothing faze this man Job?

7 What man is like Job, who drinks scorn like water?

8 Do you think he's spent too much time in bad company, hanging out with the wrong crowd,

8 He keeps company with evildoers; he associates with wicked men.

9 So that now he's parroting their line: 'It doesn't pay to try to please God'?

9 For he says, 'It profits a man nothing when he tries to please God.'

10 "You're veterans in dealing with these matters; certainly we're of one mind on this. It's impossible for God to do anything evil; no way can the Mighty One do wrong.

10 So listen to me, you men of understanding. Far be it from God to do evil, from the Almighty to do wrong.

11 He makes us pay for exactly what we've done--no more, no less. Our chickens always come home to roost.

11 He repays a man for what he has done; he brings upon him what his conduct deserves.

12 It's impossible for God to do anything wicked, for the Mighty One to subvert justice.

12 It is unthinkable that God would do wrong, that the Almighty would pervert justice.

13 He's the one who runs the earth! He cradles the whole world in his hand!

13 Who appointed him over the earth? Who put him in charge of the whole world?

14 If he decided to hold his breath,

14 If it were his intention and he withdrew his spirit and breath,

15 every man, woman, and child would die for lack of air.

15 all mankind would perish together and man would return to the dust.

16 "So, Job, use your head; this is all pretty obvious.

16 If you have understanding, hear this; listen to what I say.

- 17 Can someone who hates order, keep order? Do you dare condemn the righteous, mighty God?
- 17 Can he who hates justice govern? Will you condemn the just and mighty One?
- 18 Doesn't God always tell it like it is, exposing corrupt rulers as scoundrels and criminals?
- 18 Is he not the One who says to kings, 'You are worthless,' and to nobles, 'You are wicked,'
- 19 Does he play favorites with the rich and famous and slight the poor? Isn't he equally responsible to everybody?
- 19 who shows no partiality to princes and does not favor the rich over the poor, for they are all the work of his hands?
- 20 Don't people who deserve it die without notice? Don't wicked rulers tumble to their doom? When the so-called great ones are wiped out, we know God is working behind the scenes.
- 20 They die in an instant, in the middle of the night; the people are shaken and they pass away; the mighty are removed without human hand.
- 21 "He has his eyes on every man and woman. He doesn't miss a trick.
- 21 His eyes are on the ways of men; he sees their every step.
- 22 There is no night dark enough, no shadow deep enough, to hide those who do evil.
- 22 There is no dark place, no deep shadow, where evildoers can hide.
- 23 God doesn't need to gather any more evidence; their sin is an open-and-shut case.
- 23 God has no need to examine men further, that they should come before him for judgment.
- 24 He deposes the so-called high and mighty without asking questions, and replaces them at once with others.
- 24 Without inquiry he shatters the mighty and sets up others in their place.
- 25 Nobody gets by with anything; overnight, judgment is signed, sealed, and delivered.
- 25 Because he takes note of their deeds, he overthrows them in the night and they are crushed.
- 26 He punishes the wicked for their wickedness out in the open where everyone can see it,
- 26 He punishes them for their wickedness where everyone can see them,

27 Because they quit following him, no longer even thought about him or his ways.

27 because they turned from following him and had no regard for any of his ways.

28 Their apostasy was announced by the cry of the poor; the cry of the afflicted got God's attention.

28 They caused the cry of the poor to come before him, so that he heard the cry of the needy.

29 "If God is silent, what's that to you? If he turns his face away, what can you do about it? But whether silent or hidden, he's there, ruling,

29 But if he remains silent, who can condemn him? If he hides his face, who can see him? Yet he is over man and nation alike,

30 so that those who hate God won't take over and ruin people's lives.

30 to keep a godless man from ruling, from laying snares for the people.

31 "So why don't you simply confess to God? Say, 'I sinned, but I'll sin no more.

31 Suppose a man says to God, 'I am guilty but will offend no more.

32 Teach me to see what I still don't see. Whatever evil I've done, I'll do it no more.'

32 Teach me what I cannot see; if I have done wrong, I will not do so again.'

33 Just because you refuse to live on God's terms, do you think he should start living on yours? You choose. I can't do it for you. Tell me what you decide.

33 Should God then reward you on your terms, when you refuse to repent? You must decide, not I; so tell me what you know.

34 "All right-thinking people say-- and the wise who have listened to me concur--

34 Men of understanding declare, wise men who hear me say to me,

35 'Job is an ignoramus. He talks utter nonsense.'

35 'Job speaks without knowledge; his words lack insight.'

36 Job, you need to be pushed to the wall and called to account for wickedly talking back to God the way you have.

36 Oh, that Job might be tested to the utmost for answering like a wicked man!

37 You've compounded your original sin by rebelling against God's discipline, Defiantly shaking your fist at God, piling up indictments against the Almighty One."

37 To his sin he adds rebellion; scornfully he claps his hands among us and multiplies his words against God."

Job 35

MSG

NIV

1 Elihu lit into Job again:

1 Then Elihu said:

2 "Does this kind of thing make any sense? First you say, 'I'm perfectly innocent before God.'

2 Do you think this is just? You say, 'I will be cleared by God. '

3 And then you say, 'It doesn't make a bit of difference whether I've sinned or not.'

3 Yet you ask him, 'What profit is it to me, and what do I gain by not sinning?'

4 "Well, I'm going to show you that you don't know what you're talking about, neither you nor your friends.

4 I would like to reply to you and to your friends with you.

5 Look up at the sky. Take a long hard look. See those clouds towering above you?

5 Look up at the heavens and see; gaze at the clouds so high above you.

6 If you sin, what difference could that make to God? No matter how much you sin, will it matter to him?

6 If you sin, how does that affect him? If your sins are many, what does that do to him?

7 Even if you're good, what would God get out of that? Do you think he's dependent on your accomplishments?

7 If you are righteous, what do you give to him, or what does he receive from your hand?

8 The only ones who care whether you're good or bad are your family and friends and neighbors. God's not dependent on your behavior.

- 8 Your wickedness affects only a man like yourself, and your righteousness only the sons of men.
- 9 "When times get bad, people cry out for help. They cry for relief from being kicked around,
- 9 Men cry out under a load of oppression; they plead for relief from the arm of the powerful.
- 10 But never give God a thought when things go well, when God puts spontaneous songs in their hearts,
- 10 But no one says, 'Where is God my Maker, who gives songs in the night,
- 11 When God sets out the entire creation as a science classroom, using birds and beasts to teach wisdom.
- 11 who teaches more to us than to the beasts of the earth and makes us wiser than the birds of the air?'
- 12 People are arrogantly indifferent to God-- until, of course, they're in trouble, and then God is indifferent to them.
- 12 He does not answer when men cry out because of the arrogance of the wicked.
- 13 There's nothing behind such prayers except panic; the Almighty pays them no mind.
- 13 Indeed, God does not listen to their empty plea; the Almighty pays no attention to it.
- 14 So why would he notice you just because you say you're tired of waiting to be heard,
- 14 How much less, then, will he listen when you say that you do not see him, that your case is before him and you must wait for him,
- 15 Or waiting for him to get good and angry and do something about the world's problems?
- 15 and further, that his anger never punishes and he does not take the least notice of wickedness.
- 16 "Job, you talk sheer nonsense-- nonstop nonsense!"
- 16 So Job opens his mouth with empty talk; without knowledge he multiplies words."

Job 36

MSG

NIV

- 1 Here Elihu took a deep breath, but kept going:
- 1 Elihu continued:
- 2 "Stay with me a little longer. I'll convince you. There's still more to be said on God's side.
- 2 Bear with me a little longer and I will show you that there is more to be said in God's behalf.
- 3 I learned all this firsthand from the Source; everything I know about justice I owe to my Maker himself.
- 3 I get my knowledge from afar; I will ascribe justice to my Maker.
- 4 Trust me, I'm giving you undiluted truth; believe me, I know these things inside and out.
- 4 Be assured that my words are not false; one perfect in knowledge is with you.
- 5 "It's true that God is all-powerful, but he doesn't bully innocent people.
- 5 God is mighty, but does not despise men; he is mighty, and firm in his purpose.
- 6 For the wicked, though, it's a different story-- he doesn't give them the time of day, but champions the rights of their victims.
- 6 He does not keep the wicked alive but gives the afflicted their rights.
- 7 He never takes his eyes off the righteous; he honors them lavishly, promotes them endlessly.
- 7 He does not take his eyes off the righteous; he enthrones them with kings and exalts them forever.
- 8 When things go badly, when affliction and suffering descend,
- 8 But if men are bound in chains, held fast by cords of affliction,
- 9 God tells them where they've gone wrong, shows them how their pride has caused their trouble.
- 9 he tells them what they have done-- that they have sinned arrogantly.
- 10 He forces them to heed his warning, tells them they must repent of their bad life.
- 10 He makes them listen to correction and commands them to repent of their evil.
- 11 If they obey and serve him, they'll have a good, long life on easy street.

- 11 If they obey and serve him, they will spend the rest of their days in prosperity and their years in contentment.
- 12 But if they disobey, they'll be cut down in their prime and never know the first thing about life.
- 12 But if they do not listen, they will perish by the sword and die without knowledge.
- 13 Angry people without God pile grievance upon grievance, always blaming others for their troubles.
- 13 The godless in heart harbor resentment; even when he fetters them, they do not cry for help.
- 14 Living it up in sexual excesses, virility wasted, they die young.
- 14 They die in their youth, among male prostitutes of the shrines.
- 15 But those who learn from their suffering, God delivers from their suffering.
- 15 But those who suffer he delivers in their suffering; he speaks to them in their affliction.
- 16 "Oh, Job, don't you see how God's wooing you from the jaws of danger? How he's drawing you into wide-open places-- inviting you to feast at a table laden with blessings?
- 16 He is wooing you from the jaws of distress to a spacious place free from restriction, to the comfort of your table laden with choice food.
- 17 And here you are laden with the guilt of the wicked, obsessed with putting the blame on God!
- 17 But now you are laden with the judgment due the wicked; judgment and justice have taken hold of you.
- 18 Don't let your great riches mislead you; don't think you can bribe your way out of this.
- 18 Be careful that no one entices you by riches; do not let a large bribe turn you aside.
- 19 Did you plan to buy your way out of this? Not on your life!
- 19 Would your wealth or even all your mighty efforts sustain you so you would not be in distress?
- 20 And don't think that night, when people sleep off their troubles, will bring you any relief.
- 20 Do not long for the night, to drag people away from their homes.

- 21 Above all, don't make things worse with more evil-- that's what's behind your suffering as it is!
- 21 Beware of turning to evil, which you seem to prefer to affliction.
- 22 "Do you have any idea how powerful God is? Have you ever heard of a teacher like him?
- 22 God is exalted in his power. Who is a teacher like him?
- 23 Has anyone ever had to tell him what to do, or correct him, saying, 'You did that all wrong!'?
- 23 Who has prescribed his ways for him, or said to him, 'You have done wrong'?
- 24 Remember, then, to praise his workmanship, which is so often celebrated in song.
- 24 Remember to extol his work, which men have praised in song.
- 25 Everybody sees it; nobody is too far away to see it.
- 25 All mankind has seen it; men gaze on it from afar.
- 26 "Take a long, hard look. See how great he is--infinite, greater than anything you could ever imagine or figure out!
- 26 How great is God--beyond our understanding! The number of his years is past finding out.
- 27 "He pulls water up out of the sea, distills it, and fills up his rain-cloud cisterns.
- 27 He draws up the drops of water, which distill as rain to the streams;
- 28 Then the skies open up and pour out soaking showers on everyone.
- 28 the clouds pour down their moisture and abundant showers fall on mankind.
- 29 Does anyone have the slightest idea how this happens? How he arranges the clouds, how he speaks in thunder?
- 29 Who can understand how he spreads out the clouds, how he thunders from his pavilion?
- 30 Just look at that lightning, his sky-filling light show illumining the dark depths of the sea!
- 30 See how he scatters his lightning about him, bathing the depths of the sea.
- 31 These are the symbols of his sovereignty, his generosity, his loving care.
- 31 This is the way he governs the nations and provides food in abundance.
- 32 He hurls arrows of light, taking sure and accurate aim.

- 32 He fills his hands with lightning and commands it to strike its mark.
33 The High God roars in the thunder, angry against evil.
33 His thunder announces the coming storm; even the cattle make known its approach.

Job 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Whenever this happens, my heart stops-- I'm stunned, I can't catch my breath.
- 1 At this my heart pounds and leaps from its place.
- 2 Listen to it! Listen to his thunder, the rolling, rumbling thunder of his voice.
- 2 Listen! Listen to the roar of his voice, to the rumbling that comes from his mouth.
- 3 He lets loose his lightnings from horizon to horizon, lighting up the earth from pole to pole.
- 3 He unleashes his lightning beneath the whole heaven and sends it to the ends of the earth.
- 4 In their wake, the thunder echoes his voice, powerful and majestic. He lets out all the stops, he holds nothing back. No one can mistake that voice--
- 4 After that comes the sound of his roar; he thunders with his majestic voice. When his voice resounds, he holds nothing back.
- 5 His word thundering so wondrously, his mighty acts staggering our understanding.
- 5 God's voice thunders in marvelous ways; he does great things beyond our understanding.
- 6 He orders the snow, 'Blanket the earth!' and the rain, 'Soak the whole countryside!'
- 6 He says to the snow, 'Fall on the earth,' and to the rain shower, 'Be a mighty downpour.'
- 7 No one can escape the weather--it's there. And no one can escape from God.

- 7 So that all men he has made may know his work, he stops every man from his labor.
- 8 Wild animals take shelter, crawling into their dens,
8 The animals take cover; they remain in their dens.
- 9 When blizzards roar out of the north and freezing rain crusts the land.
9 The tempest comes out from its chamber, the cold from the driving winds.
- 10 It's God's breath that forms the ice, it's God's breath that turns lakes and rivers solid.
- 10 The breath of God produces ice, and the broad waters become frozen.
- 11 And yes, it's God who fills clouds with rainwater and hurls lightning from them every which way.
- 11 He loads the clouds with moisture; he scatters his lightning through them.
- 12 He puts them through their paces--first this way, then that-- commands them to do what he says all over the world.
- 12 At his direction they swirl around over the face of the whole earth to do whatever he commands them.
- 13 Whether for discipline or grace or extravagant love, he makes sure they make their mark.
- 13 He brings the clouds to punish men, or to water his earth and show his love.
- 14 "Job, are you listening? Have you noticed all this? Stop in your tracks! Take in God's miracle-wonders!
- 14 Listen to this, Job; stop and consider God's wonders.
- 15 Do you have any idea how God does it all, how he makes bright lightning from dark storms,
15 Do you know how God controls the clouds and makes his lightning flash?
- 16 How he piles up the cumulus clouds-- all these miracle-wonders of a perfect Mind?
- 16 Do you know how the clouds hang poised, those wonders of him who is perfect in knowledge?
- 17 Why, you don't even know how to keep cool on a sweltering hot day,
17 You who swelter in your clothes when the land lies hushed under the south wind,

- 18 So how could you even dream of making a dent in that hot-tin-roof sky?
18 can you join him in spreading out the skies, hard as a mirror of cast bronze?
- 19 "If you're so smart, give us a lesson in how to address God. We're in the dark and can't figure it out.
19 Tell us what we should say to him; we cannot draw up our case because of our darkness.
- 20 Do you think I'm dumb enough to challenge God? Wouldn't that just be asking for trouble?
20 Should he be told that I want to speak? Would any man ask to be swallowed up?
- 21 No one in his right mind stares straight at the sun on a clear and cloudless day.
21 Now no one can look at the sun, bright as it is in the skies after the wind has swept them clean.
- 22 As gold comes from the northern mountains, so a terrible beauty streams from God.
22 Out of the north he comes in golden splendor; God comes in awesome majesty.
- 23 "Mighty God! Far beyond our reach! Unsurpassable in power and justice! It's unthinkable that he'd treat anyone unfairly.
23 The Almighty is beyond our reach and exalted in power; in his justice and great righteousness, he does not oppress.
- 24 So bow to him in deep reverence, one and all! If you're wise, you'll most certainly worship him."
24 Therefore, men revere him, for does he not have regard for all the wise in heart? "

Job 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 And now, finally, GOD answered Job from the eye of a violent storm. He said:
1 Then the LORD answered Job out of the storm. He said:

2 "Why do you confuse the issue? Why do you talk without knowing what
you're talking about?
2 Who is this that darkens my counsel with words without knowledge?
3 Pull yourself together, Job! Up on your feet! Stand tall! I have some
questions for you, and I want some straight answers.
3 Brace yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall answer me.
4 Where were you when I created the earth? Tell me, since you know so
much!
4 Where were you when I laid the earth's foundation? Tell me, if you
understand.
5 Who decided on its size? Certainly you'll know that! Who came up with
the blueprints and measurements?
5 Who marked off its dimensions? Surely you know! Who stretched a
measuring line across it?
6 How was its foundation poured, and who set the cornerstone,
6 On what were its footings set, or who laid its cornerstone--
7 While the morning stars sang in chorus and all the angels shouted praise?
7 while the morning stars sang together and all the angels shouted for joy?
8 And who took charge of the ocean when it gushed forth like a baby from
the womb?
8 Who shut up the sea behind doors when it burst forth from the womb,
9 That was me! I wrapped it in soft clouds, and tucked it in safely at night.
9 when I made the clouds its garment and wrapped it in thick darkness,
10 Then I made a playpen for it, a strong playpen so it couldn't run loose,
10 when I fixed limits for it and set its doors and bars in place,
11 And said, 'Stay here, this is your place. Your wild tantrums are confined
to this place.'
11 when I said, 'This far you may come and no farther; here is where your
proud waves halt'?
12 "And have you ever ordered Morning, 'Get up!' told Dawn, 'Get to
work!'
12 Have you ever given orders to the morning, or shown the dawn its
place,
13 So you could seize Earth like a blanket and shake out the wicked like
cockroaches?
13 that it might take the earth by the edges and shake the wicked out of it?

- 14 As the sun brings everything to light, brings out all the colors and shapes,
- 14 The earth takes shape like clay under a seal; its features stand out like those of a garment.
- 15 The cover of darkness is snatched from the wicked-- they're caught in the very act!
- 15 The wicked are denied their light, and their upraised arm is broken.
- 16 "Have you ever gotten to the true bottom of things, explored the labyrinthine caves of deep ocean?
- 16 Have you journeyed to the springs of the sea or walked in the recesses of the deep?
- 17 Do you know the first thing about death? Do you have one clue regarding death's dark mysteries?
- 17 Have the gates of death been shown to you? Have you seen the gates of the shadow of death?
- 18 And do you have any idea how large this earth is? Speak up if you have even the beginning of an answer.
- 18 Have you comprehended the vast expanses of the earth? Tell me, if you know all this.
- 19 "Do you know where Light comes from and where Darkness lives
- 19 What is the way to the abode of light? And where does darkness reside?
- 20 So you can take them by the hand and lead them home when they get lost?
- 20 Can you take them to their places? Do you know the paths to their dwellings?
- 21 Why, of course you know that. You've known them all your life, grown up in the same neighborhood with them!
- 21 Surely you know, for you were already born! You have lived so many years!
- 22 "Have you ever traveled to where snow is made, seen the vault where hail is stockpiled,
- 22 Have you entered the storehouses of the snow or seen the storehouses of the hail,
- 23 The arsenals of hail and snow that I keep in readiness for times of trouble and battle and war?
- 23 which I reserve for times of trouble, for days of war and battle?

- 24 Can you find your way to where lightning is launched, or to the place from which the wind blows?
- 24 What is the way to the place where the lightning is dispersed, or the place where the east winds are scattered over the earth?
- 25 Who do you suppose carves canyons for the downpours of rain, and charts the route of thunderstorms
- 25 Who cuts a channel for the torrents of rain, and a path for the thunderstorm,
- 26 That bring water to unvisited fields, deserts no one ever lays eyes on,
- 26 to water a land where no man lives, a desert with no one in it,
- 27 Drenching the useless wastelands so they're carpeted with wildflowers and grass?
- 27 to satisfy a desolate wasteland and make it sprout with grass?
- 28 And who do you think is the father of rain and dew,
- 28 Does the rain have a father? Who fathers the drops of dew?
- 29 the mother of ice and frost?
- 29 From whose womb comes the ice? Who gives birth to the frost from the heavens
- 30 You don't for a minute imagine these marvels of weather just happen, do you?
- 30 when the waters become hard as stone, when the surface of the deep is frozen?
- 31 "Can you catch the eye of the beautiful Pleiades sisters, or distract Orion from his hunt?
- 31 Can you bind the beautiful Pleiades? Can you loose the cords of Orion?
- 32 Can you get Venus to look your way, or get the Great Bear and her cubs to come out and play?
- 32 Can you bring forth the constellations in their seasons or lead out the Bear with its cubs?
- 33 Do you know the first thing about the sky's constellations and how they affect things on Earth?
- 33 Do you know the laws of the heavens? Can you set up God's dominion over the earth?
- 34 "Can you get the attention of the clouds, and commission a shower of rain?

- 34 Can you raise your voice to the clouds and cover yourself with a flood of water?
- 35 Can you take charge of the lightning bolts and have them report to you for orders?
- 35 Do you send the lightning bolts on their way? Do they report to you, 'Here we are'?
- 36 "Who do you think gave weather-wisdom to the ibis, and storm-savvy to the rooster?
- 36 Who endowed the heart with wisdom or gave understanding to the mind?
- 37 Does anyone know enough to number all the clouds or tip over the rain barrels of heaven
- 37 Who has the wisdom to count the clouds? Who can tip over the water jars of the heavens
- 38 When the earth is cracked and dry, the ground baked hard as a brick?
- 38 when the dust becomes hard and the clods of earth stick together?
- 39 "Can you teach the lioness to stalk her prey and satisfy the appetite of her cubs
- 39 Do you hunt the prey for the lioness and satisfy the hunger of the lions
- 40 As they crouch in their den, waiting hungrily in their cave?
- 40 when they crouch in their dens or lie in wait in a thicket?
- 41 And who sets out food for the ravens when their young cry to God, fluttering about because they have no food?
- 41 Who provides food for the raven when its young cry out to God and wander about for lack of food?

Job 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Do you know the month when mountain goats give birth? Have you ever watched a doe bear her fawn?
- 1 Do you know when the mountain goats give birth? Do you watch when the doe bears her fawn?
- 2 Do you know how many months she is pregnant? Do you know the season of her delivery,

- 2 Do you count the months till they bear? Do you know the time they give birth?
- 3 when she crouches down and drops her offspring?
- 3 They crouch down and bring forth their young; their labor pains are ended.
- 4 Her young ones flourish and are soon on their own; they leave and don't come back.
- 4 Their young thrive and grow strong in the wilds; they leave and do not return.
- 5 "Who do you think set the wild donkey free, opened the corral gates and let him go?
- 5 Who let the wild donkey go free? Who untied his ropes?
- 6 I gave him the whole wilderness to roam in, the rolling plains and wide-open places.
- 6 I gave him the wasteland as his home, the salt flats as his habitat.
- 7 He laughs at his city cousins, who are harnessed and harried. He's oblivious to the cries of teamsters.
- 7 He laughs at the commotion in the town; he does not hear a driver's shout.
- 8 He grazes freely through the hills, nibbling anything that's green.
- 8 He ranges the hills for his pasture and searches for any green thing.
- 9 "Will the wild buffalo condescend to serve you, volunteer to spend the night in your barn?
- 9 Will the wild ox consent to serve you? Will he stay by your manger at night?
- 10 Can you imagine hitching your plow to a buffalo and getting him to till your fields?
- 10 Can you hold him to the furrow with a harness? Will he till the valleys behind you?
- 11 He's hugely strong, yes, but could you trust him, would you dare turn the job over to him?
- 11 Will you rely on him for his great strength? Will you leave your heavy work to him?
- 12 You wouldn't for a minute depend on him, would you, to do what you said when you said it?

- 12 Can you trust him to bring in your grain and gather it to your threshing floor?
- 13 "The ostrich flaps her wings futilely-- all those beautiful feathers, but useless!
- 13 The wings of the ostrich flap joyfully, but they cannot compare with the pinions and feathers of the stork.
- 14 She lays her eggs on the hard ground, leaves them there in the dirt, exposed to the weather,
- 14 She lays her eggs on the ground and lets them warm in the sand,
- 15 Not caring that they might get stepped on and cracked or trampled by some wild animal.
- 15 unmindful that a foot may crush them, that some wild animal may trample them.
- 16 She's negligent with her young, as if they weren't even hers. She cares nothing about anything.
- 16 She treats her young harshly, as if they were not hers; she cares not that her labor was in vain,
- 17 She wasn't created very smart, that's for sure, wasn't given her share of good sense.
- 17 for God did not endow her with wisdom or give her a share of good sense.
- 18 But when she runs, oh, how she runs, laughing, leaving horse and rider in the dust.
- 18 Yet when she spreads her feathers to run, she laughs at horse and rider.
- 19 "Are you the one who gave the horse his prowess and adorned him with a shimmering mane?
- 19 Do you give the horse his strength or clothe his neck with a flowing mane?
- 20 Did you create him to prance proudly and strike terror with his royal snorts?
- 20 Do you make him leap like a locust, striking terror with his proud snorting?
- 21 He paws the ground fiercely, eager and spirited, then charges into the fray.
- 21 He paws fiercely, rejoicing in his strength, and charges into the fray.
- 22 He laughs at danger, fearless, doesn't shy away from the sword.

- 22 He laughs at fear, afraid of nothing; he does not shy away from the sword.
- 23 The banging and clanging of quiver and lance don't faze him.
- 23 The quiver rattles against his side, along with the flashing spear and lance.
- 24 He quivers with excitement, and at the trumpet blast races off at a gallop.
- 24 In frenzied excitement he eats up the ground; he cannot stand still when the trumpet sounds.
- 25 At the sound of the trumpet he neighs mightily, smelling the excitement of battle from a long way off, catching the rolling thunder of the war cries.
- 25 At the blast of the trumpet he snorts, 'Aha!' He catches the scent of battle from afar, the shout of commanders and the battle cry.
- 26 "Was it through your know how that the hawk learned to fly, soaring effortlessly on thermal updrafts?
- 26 Does the hawk take flight by your wisdom and spread his wings toward the south?
- 27 Did you command the eagle's flight, and teach her to build her nest in the heights,
- 27 Does the eagle soar at your command and build his nest on high?
- 28 Perfectly at home on the high cliff-face, invulnerable on pinnacle and crag?
- 28 He dwells on a cliff and stays there at night; a rocky crag is his stronghold.
- 29 From her perch she searches for prey, spies it at a great distance.
- 29 From there he seeks out his food; his eyes detect it from afar.
- 30 Her young gorge themselves on carrion; wherever there's a roadkill, you'll see her circling."
- 30 His young ones feast on blood, and where the slain are, there is he."

Job 40

MSG

NIV

1 GOD then confronted Job directly:

1 The LORD said to Job:
2 "Now what do you have to say for yourself? Are you going to haul me, the Mighty One, into court and press charges?"
2 Will the one who contends with the Almighty correct him? Let him who accuses God answer him!
3 Job answered:
3 Then Job answered the LORD:
4 "I'm speechless, in awe--words fail me. I should never have opened my mouth!
4 I am unworthy--how can I reply to you? I put my hand over my mouth.
5 I've talked too much, way too much. I'm ready to shut up and listen."
5 I spoke once, but I have no answer-- twice, but I will say no more."
6 GOD addressed Job next from the eye of the storm, and this is what he said:
6 Then the LORD spoke to Job out of the storm:
7 "I have some more questions for you, and I want straight answers.
7 Brace yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall answer me.
8 "Do you presume to tell me what I'm doing wrong? Are you calling me a sinner so you can be a saint?
8 Would you discredit my justice? Would you condemn me to justify yourself?
9 Do you have an arm like my arm? Can you shout in thunder the way I can?
9 Do you have an arm like God's, and can your voice thunder like his?
10 Go ahead, show your stuff. Let's see what you're made of, what you can do.
10 Then adorn yourself with glory and splendor, and clothe yourself in honor and majesty.
11 Unleash your outrage. Target the arrogant and lay them flat.
11 Unleash the fury of your wrath, look at every proud man and bring him low,
12 Target the arrogant and bring them to their knees. Stop the wicked in their tracks--make mincemeat of them!
12 look at every proud man and humble him, crush the wicked where they stand.

- 13 Dig a mass grave and dump them in it-- faceless corpses in an unmarked grave.
- 13 Bury them all in the dust together; shroud their faces in the grave.
- 14 I'll gladly step aside and hand things over to you-- you can surely save yourself with no help from me!
- 14 Then I myself will admit to you that your own right hand can save you.
- 15 "Look at the land beast, Behemoth. I created him as well as you. Grazing on grass, docile as a cow--
- 15 Look at the behemoth, which I made along with you and which feeds on grass like an ox.
- 16 Just look at the strength of his back, the powerful muscles of his belly.
- 16 What strength he has in his loins, what power in the muscles of his belly!
- 17 His tail sways like a cedar in the wind; his huge legs are like beech trees.
- 17 His tail sways like a cedar; the sinews of his thighs are close-knit.
- 18 His skeleton is made of steel, every bone in his body hard as steel.
- 18 His bones are tubes of bronze, his limbs like rods of iron.
- 19 Most magnificent of all my creatures, but I still lead him around like a lamb!
- 19 He ranks first among the works of God, yet his Maker can approach him with his sword.
- 20 The grass-covered hills serve him meals, while field mice frolic in his shadow.
- 20 The hills bring him their produce, and all the wild animals play nearby.
- 21 He takes afternoon naps under shade trees, cools himself in the reedy swamps,
- 21 Under the lotus plants he lies, hidden among the reeds in the marsh.
- 22 Lazily cool in the leafy shadows as the breeze moves through the willows.
- 22 The lotuses conceal him in their shadow; the poplars by the stream surround him.
- 23 And when the river rages he doesn't budge, stolid and unperturbed even when the Jordan goes wild.
- 23 When the river rages, he is not alarmed; he is secure, though the Jordan should surge against his mouth.

24 But you'd never want him for a pet-- you'd never be able to housebreak him!

24 Can anyone capture him by the eyes, or trap him and pierce his nose?

Job 41

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Or can you pull in the sea beast, Leviathan, with a fly rod and stuff him in your creel?
- 1 Can you pull in the leviathan with a fishhook or tie down his tongue with a rope?
- 2 Can you lasso him with a rope, or snag him with an anchor?
- 2 Can you put a cord through his nose or pierce his jaw with a hook?
- 3 Will he beg you over and over for mercy, or flatter you with flowery speech?
- 3 Will he keep begging you for mercy? Will he speak to you with gentle words?
- 4 Will he apply for a job with you to run errands and serve you the rest of your life?
- 4 Will he make an agreement with you for you to take him as your slave for life?
- 5 Will you play with him as if he were a pet goldfish? Will you make him the mascot of the neighborhood children?
- 5 Can you make a pet of him like a bird or put him on a leash for your girls?
- 6 Will you put him on display in the market and have shoppers haggle over the price?
- 6 Will traders barter for him? Will they divide him up among the merchants?
- 7 Could you shoot him full of arrows like a pin cushion, or drive harpoons into his huge head?
- 7 Can you fill his hide with harpoons or his head with fishing spears?
- 8 If you so much as lay a hand on him, you won't live to tell the story.
- 8 If you lay a hand on him, you will remember the struggle and never do it again!

- 9 What hope would you have with such a creature? Why, one look at him would do you in!
- 9 Any hope of subduing him is false; the mere sight of him is overpowering.
- 10 If you can't hold your own against his glowering visage, how, then, do you expect to stand up to me?
- 10 No one is fierce enough to rouse him. Who then is able to stand against me?
- 11 Who could confront me and get by with it? I'm in charge of all this--I run this universe!
- 11 Who has a claim against me that I must pay? Everything under heaven belongs to me.
- 12 "But I've more to say about Leviathan, the sea beast, his enormous bulk, his beautiful shape.
- 12 I will not fail to speak of his limbs, his strength and his graceful form.
- 13 Who would even dream of piercing that tough skin or putting those jaws into bit and bridle?
- 13 Who can strip off his outer coat? Who would approach him with a bridle?
- 14 And who would dare knock at the door of his mouth filled with row upon row of fierce teeth?
- 14 Who dares open the doors of his mouth, ringed about with his fearsome teeth?
- 15 His pride is invincible; nothing can make a dent in that pride.
- 15 His back has rows of shields tightly sealed together;
- 16 Nothing can get through that proud skin-- impervious to weapons and weather,
- 16 each is so close to the next that no air can pass between.
- 17 The thickest and toughest of hides, impenetrable!
- 17 They are joined fast to one another; they cling together and cannot be parted.
- 18 "He snorts and the world lights up with fire, he blinks and the dawn breaks.
- 18 His snorting throws out flashes of light; his eyes are like the rays of dawn.
- 19 Comets pour out of his mouth, fireworks arc and branch.

19 Firebrands stream from his mouth; sparks of fire shoot out.
20 Smoke erupts from his nostrils like steam from a boiling pot.
20 Smoke pours from his nostrils as from a boiling pot over a fire of reeds.
21 He blows and fires blaze; flames of fire stream from his mouth.
21 His breath sets coals ablaze, and flames dart from his mouth.
22 All muscle he is--sheer and seamless muscle. To meet him is to dance with death.
22 Strength resides in his neck; dismay goes before him.
23 Sinewy and lithe, there's not a soft spot in his entire body--
23 The folds of his flesh are tightly joined; they are firm and immovable.
24 As tough inside as out, rock-hard, invulnerable.
24 His chest is hard as rock, hard as a lower millstone.
25 Even angels run for cover when he surfaces, cowering before his tail-thrashing turbulence.
25 When he rises up, the mighty are terrified; they retreat before his thrashing.
26 Javelins bounce harmlessly off his hide, harpoons ricochet wildly.
26 The sword that reaches him has no effect, nor does the spear or the dart or the javelin.
27 Iron bars are so much straw to him, bronze weapons beneath notice.
27 Iron he treats like straw and bronze like rotten wood.
28 Arrows don't even make him blink; bullets make no more impression than raindrops.
28 Arrows do not make him flee; slingstones are like chaff to him.
29 A battle ax is nothing but a splinter of kindling; he treats a brandished harpoon as a joke.
29 A club seems to him but a piece of straw; he laughs at the rattling of the lance.
30 His belly is armor-plated, inexorable-- unstoppable as a barge.
30 His undersides are jagged potsherds, leaving a trail in the mud like a threshing sledge.
31 He roils deep ocean the way you'd boil water, he whips the sea like you'd whip an egg into batter.
31 He makes the depths churn like a boiling caldron and stirs up the sea like a pot of ointment.

- 32 With a luminous trail stretching out behind him, you might think Ocean had grown a gray beard!
- 32 Behind him he leaves a glistening wake; one would think the deep had white hair.
- 33 There's nothing on this earth quite like him, not an ounce of fear in that creature!
- 33 Nothing on earth is his equal-- a creature without fear.
- 34 He surveys all the high and mighty-- king of the ocean, king of the deep!"
- 34 He looks down on all that are haughty; he is king over all that are proud."

Job 42

MSG

NIV

- 1 Job answered GOD:
- 1 Then Job replied to the LORD:
- 2 "I'm convinced: You can do anything and everything. Nothing and no one can upset your plans.
- 2 I know that you can do all things; no plan of yours can be thwarted.
- 3 You asked, 'Who is this muddying the water, ignorantly confusing the issue, second-guessing my purposes?' I admit it. I was the one. I babbled on about things far beyond me, made small talk about wonders way over my head.
- 3 You asked, 'Who is this that obscures my counsel without knowledge?' Surely I spoke of things I did not understand, things too wonderful for me to know.
- 4 You told me, 'Listen, and let me do the talking. Let me ask the questions. You give the answers.'
- 4 You said, 'Listen now, and I will speak; I will question you, and you shall answer me.'
- 5 I admit I once lived by rumors of you; now I have it all firsthand--from my own eyes and ears!
- 5 My ears had heard of you but now my eyes have seen you.

- 6 I'm sorry--forgive me. I'll never do that again, I promise! I'll never again live on crusts of hearsay, crumbs of rumor."
- 6 Therefore I despise myself and repent in dust and ashes."
- 7 After GOD had finished addressing Job, he turned to Eliphaz the Temanite and said, "I've had it with you and your two friends. I'm fed up! You haven't been honest either with me or about me--not the way my friend Job has.
- 7 After the LORD had said these things to Job, he said to Eliphaz the Temanite, "I am angry with you and your two friends, because you have not spoken of me what is right, as my servant Job has.
- 8 So here's what you must do. Take seven bulls and seven rams, and go to my friend Job. Sacrifice a burnt offering on your own behalf. My friend Job will pray for you, and I will accept his prayer. He will ask me not to treat you as you deserve for talking nonsense about me, and for not being honest with me, as he has."
- 8 So now take seven bulls and seven rams and go to my servant Job and sacrifice a burnt offering for yourselves. My servant Job will pray for you, and I will accept his prayer and not deal with you according to your folly. You have not spoken of me what is right, as my servant Job has."
- 9 They did it. Eliphaz the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite did what GOD commanded. And GOD accepted Job's prayer.
- 9 So Eliphaz the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite did what the LORD told them; and the LORD accepted Job's prayer.
- 10 After Job had interceded for his friends, GOD restored his fortune--and then doubled it!
- 10 After Job had prayed for his friends, the LORD made him prosperous again and gave him twice as much as he had before.
- 11 All his brothers and sisters and friends came to his house and celebrated. They told him how sorry they were, and consoled him for all the trouble GOD had brought him. Each of them brought generous housewarming gifts.
- 11 All his brothers and sisters and everyone who had known him before came and ate with him in his house. They comforted and consoled him over all the trouble the LORD had brought upon him, and each one gave him a piece of silver and a gold ring.

- 12 GOD blessed Job's later life even more than his earlier life. He ended up with fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, one thousand teams of oxen, and one thousand donkeys.
- 12 The LORD blessed the latter part of Job's life more than the first. He had fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, a thousand yoke of oxen and a thousand donkeys.
- 13 He also had seven sons and three daughters.
- 13 And he also had seven sons and three daughters.
- 14 He named the first daughter Dove, the second, Cinnamon, and the third, Darkeyes.
- 14 The first daughter he named Jemimah, the second Keziah and the third Keren-Happuch.
- 15 There was not a woman in that country as beautiful as Job's daughters. Their father treated them as equals with their brothers, providing the same inheritance.
- 15 Nowhere in all the land were there found women as beautiful as Job's daughters, and their father granted them an inheritance along with their brothers.
- 16 Job lived on another hundred and forty years, living to see his children and grandchildren--four generations of them!
- 16 After this, Job lived a hundred and forty years; he saw his children and their children to the fourth generation.
- 17 Then he died--an old man, a full life.
- 17 And so he died, old and full of years.